

Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation)

COMPLETE MULTI-PAGE FLOWCHART COMPANION

Basic -> Optional Advanced -> Register Retrieval -> PYQ Routes & Answer Spine

Landscape visual edition | Source-complete learner-v2 | 21 August 2026

Reading rule: follow the vertical arrows. Each continuation card retains source-owned definitions, classifications, derivations, objections, replies, comparisons, traps and recall cues. Practice prose is not duplicated; only verified question routes and answer architecture are mapped.

TECHNICAL-TERM TRANSLATION GATEWAY

Every Sanskrit, Pali, Prakrit or Hindi technical expression used later is introduced here with its immediate exam-safe English meaning. Prominent visual maps repeat the translation so no diagram depends on untranslated labels.

Technical term (immediate English meaning)	Technical term (immediate English meaning)	Technical term (immediate English meaning)
āstika (Veda-affirming or orthodox school)	nāstika (Veda-rejecting or heterodox school)	ātman (enduring self or soul)
anātman (no permanent self)	anātmavāda (doctrine of no permanent self)	anīśvaravāda (denial of a creator God)
Īśvara (Lord or creator God)	karma (action and its morally consequential residue)	saṃsāra (cycle of rebirth and suffering)
mokṣa (liberation)	nirvāṇa (cessation of craving and conditioned suffering)	dharma (doctrine, duty or constitutive factor, as context requires)
adharma (non-duty or, in Jainism, the medium enabling rest)	pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge)	pramā (valid cognition)
pratyakṣa (perception)	anumāna (inference)	śabda (verbal testimony)
upamāna (comparison or analogy)	arthāpatti (postulation or presumption)	anupalabdhi (non-cognition used to know absence)
vyāpti (invariable concomitance)	upādhi (hidden limiting condition)	tarka (hypothetical or reductio reasoning)
anvaya (positive agreement in presence)	vyatireka (negative agreement in absence)	anvaya-vyatireka (joint method of agreement in presence and absence)
pūrvapakṣa (opponent's prima-facie position)	siddhānta (established conclusion)	śāstra (authoritative treatise or discipline)
sūtra (concise aphoristic text)	darśana (philosophical system or vision)	guṇa (quality)
dravya (substance)	paryāya (changing mode)	puruṣa (person or conscious principle)
prakṛti (type or nature of bondage)	manas (mind)	rūpa (material form)
vedanā (feeling)	saṃjñā (recognition or perception)	saṃskāra (mental formation or disposition)
vijñāna (consciousness)	avidyā (ignorance)	trṣṇā (craving)
upādāna (clinging or grasping)	jāti (birth)	jarā-maraṇa (ageing and death)
bija (causal seed or latent potency)	svabhāva (intrinsic own-nature)	sat (being or reality)
duḥkha (suffering or unsatisfactoriness)	ahiṃsā (non-violence)	apūrva (unseen ritual potency)
adrṣṭa (unseen causal force)	Mīmāṃsā (Vedic exegesis school)	Nyāya (school of logic and epistemology)
Vaiśeṣika (school of categories and atomism)	Sāṃkhya (dualistic enumeration school)	Vedānta (Upaniṣad-based end-of-the-Veda tradition)
Yogācāra (Buddhist consciousness-only school)	Mādhyamika (Buddhist middle-way emptiness school)	jīva (living conscious substance or soul)

Technical term (immediate English meaning)	Technical term (immediate English meaning)	Technical term (immediate English meaning)
jñāna (knowledge)	Cārvāka (Indian materialist and perception-centred school)	Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika (combined realist traditions of logic and categories)
Sāṃkhya-Yoga (paired traditions of dualist enumeration and disciplined practice)	Vedāntic (relating to an Upaniṣad-based Vedānta tradition)	Upaniṣadic (relating to the philosophical Upaniṣads)
śruti (revealed Vedic scripture)	Naiyāyika (adherent of the Nyāya school)	pāramārthika (ultimate level)
arthakriyā (causal efficacy)	Śūnyavāda (doctrine of emptiness)	anekānta (many-sidedness)
bhaṅga (predicative mode)	bhaṅgas (seven predicative modes)	nairātmya (absence of a permanent self)
Nyaya (school of logic and epistemology)	Vaisesika (school of categories and atomism)	Samkhya (dualistic enumeration school)
Vedanta (Upaniṣad-based end-of-the-Veda tradition)	Mimamsa (Vedic exegesis school)	Isvara (Lord or creator God)
atman (enduring self or soul)	moksa (liberation)	nirvana (cessation of craving and conditioned suffering)
Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation)	Jina (spiritual conqueror)	Tirthaṅkara (liberated ford-maker and teacher)
Tattvārthasūtra (Aphorisms on the Meaning of Reality)	Tattvārthādhigama-sūtra (Aphorisms for Understanding Reality)	anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality)
nayavāda (theory of partial standpoints)	syādvāda (doctrine of qualified or conditional assertion)	saptabhaṅgī (sevenfold predication)
saptabhaṅgīnaya (sevenfold standpoint-based judgement)	naya (partial standpoint)	nayas (partial standpoints)
syāt (in a certain respect or conditionally)	avaktavya (inexpressible under a simultaneous unqualified formulation)	utpāda (origination)
vyaya (cessation or decay)	dhrauvya (persistence)	utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya (origination, decay and persistence)
ajīva (non-living reality)	pudgala (matter capable of combination and disintegration)	astikāya (extended substance occupying spatial points)
astikāyas (extended substances occupying spatial points)	an-astikāya (non-extended substance)	dharma-dravya (medium enabling motion)
adharma-dravya (medium enabling rest)	ākāśa (space)	kāla (time)
lokākāśa (inhabited cosmic space)	alokākāśa (space beyond the inhabited cosmos)	ratna-traya (three jewels of right vision, knowledge and conduct)
samyag-darśana (right vision or faith)	samyag-jñāna (right knowledge)	samyak-cāritra (right conduct)
mati (sense-and-mind cognition)	śruta (scriptural or verbal cognition)	avadhi (clairvoyant knowledge)
manaḥparyāya (direct knowledge of others' mental states)	kevala (perfect and unobstructed)	kevala-jñāna (perfect omniscience)
parokṣa (indirect or mediated knowledge)	sāṃvyaavahārika pratyakṣa (conventionally direct ordinary cognition)	pāramārthika pratyakṣa (ultimately direct unmediated cognition)
kṣāyopaśamika (arising through partial destruction and suppression of karmic obstruction)	mithyā-darśana (wrong or deluded worldview)	ajñāna (wrong cognition or ignorance)

Technical term (immediate English meaning)	Technical term (immediate English meaning)	Technical term (immediate English meaning)
āgama (authoritative teaching or scripture)	smṛti (memory)	ūha (reasoned reflection)
ananta-dharmātmaka (possessing infinitely many aspects)	ekāntavāda (one-sided absolutism)	saṃgraha-naya (generic or class standpoint)
vyavahāra-naya (practical or particular standpoint)	r̥jusūtra-naya (momentary present-mode standpoint)	śabda-naya (verbal standpoint)
samabhirūḍha-naya (etymologically differentiated standpoint)	evambhūta-naya (actualised usage standpoint)	tattva (fundamental category of reality and liberation)
tattvas (fundamental categories of reality and liberation)	padārtha (ontological category)	padārthas (ontological categories)
āsrava (influx of karmic matter)	bandha (bondage)	saṃvara (stoppage of karmic influx)
nirjarā (shedding of accumulated karma)	bhāvabandha (psychic or intentional bondage)	dravyabandha (material karmic bondage)
punya (merit)	pāpa (demerit)	kaṣāya (passion binding karma)
karma-prakṛti (type or nature of karma)	ghātiyā (destructive karma obscuring essential capacities)	aghātiyā (non-destructive karma shaping embodiment)
jñānāvaraṇīya (knowledge-obscuring karma)	darśanāvaraṇīya (perception-obscuring karma)	mohaniya (deluding karma)
antarāya (obstructive karma)	vedaniya (feeling-producing karma)	nāma (body-making karma)
āyus (lifespan-determining karma)	gotra (status-determining karma)	sthiti (duration)
anubhāga (intensity)	pradeśa (quantity of karmic particles or spatial points)	īryāpathika (momentary activity-linked bondage without passion)
sāmparāyika (durable bondage coloured by passion)	guṇasthāna (stage of spiritual development)	guṇasthānas (fourteen stages of spiritual development)
mithyā-dṛṣṭi (stage of false worldview)	sāsvādana (stage retaining a taste of right vision)	miśra (mixed worldview stage)
deśavirata (partial self-restraint stage)	pramatta-saṃyata (self-restraint with carelessness)	apramatta-saṃyata (self-restraint without carelessness)
apūrva-karaṇa (unprecedented spiritual transformation)	anivṛtti-bādara (advanced stage with gross passions being transformed)	sūkṣma-samparāya (stage of only subtle passion)
upaśānta-moha (stage of suppressed delusion)	kṣiṇa-moha (stage of destroyed delusion)	sayoga-kevali (omniscient being still engaged in activity)
ayoga-kevali (omniscient being without bodily activity)	siddha (liberated perfected soul)	siddha-śilā (realm of liberated souls)
sallekhanā (ritual thinning of passions and body near unavoidable death)	santhārā (vow of disciplined fasting near unavoidable death)	ātma-ghāta (self-killing or suicide)
jīvanmukti (liberation while embodied)	mahāvrata (great ascetic vow)	mahāvratas (five great ascetic vows)
ananta-catuṣṭaya (four infinite perfections of knowledge, perception, bliss and power)	pañcāstikāya (five extended substances)	karma-prakṛtis (types or species of karma)
anekantavada (doctrine of many-sided reality)	nayavada (theory of partial standpoints)	syadvada (doctrine of qualified or conditional assertion)
saptabhangi (sevenfold predication)	jīva (living conscious substance or soul)	ajīva (non-living reality)
asrava (influx of karmic matter)	samvara (stoppage of karmic influx)	nirjara (shedding of accumulated karma)

Technical term (immediate English meaning)	Technical term (immediate English meaning)	Technical term (immediate English meaning)
syād (in a certain respect or conditionally)	nāsti (it is not)	anādi (beginningless)
bhāva (psychic state or mode)	niścaya-naya (ultimate or substantive standpoint)	kuśruta (erroneous verbal cognition)
vibhaṅga-jñāna (wrong clairvoyant cognition)	kṣetra (field, body or domain)	mithyātva (delusion or false worldview)
aticāra (minor transgression of a vow)	adhyāsa (superimposition)	vāsanā (latent disposition)
saṃsāric (bound within the cycle of rebirth)	jīvanmukta (one liberated while living)	satkāryavāda (doctrine that the effect pre-exists in its cause)
asatkāryavāda (doctrine that the effect is newly produced)	Sadasatkāryavāda (doctrine that the effect is both existent and non-existent in qualified respects)	sapta-bhaṅgī (sevenfold predication)
Jīva-karma (relation between the soul and karmic matter)	ātman-Brahman (identity of self and ultimate reality)	karmas (plural form: action and its morally consequential residue)
pramāṇas (plural form: means of valid knowledge)	guṇas (plural form: quality)	dravyas (plural form: substance)
paryāyas (plural form: changing mode)	puruṣas (plural form: person or conscious principle)	jīvas (plural form: living conscious substance or soul)
jñānas (plural form: knowledge)	Tīrthaṅkaras (plural form: liberated ford-maker and teacher)	kaṣāyas (plural form: passion binding karma)
pradeśas (plural form: quantity of karmic particles or spatial points)	siddhas (plural form: liberated perfected soul)	

MASTER LEARNING SEQUENCE

01 0. ONE-SCREEN MAP	02 0A. UMĀSVĀTĪ / UMĀSVĀMĪ AND THE TATTVĀRTHASŪTRA (Aphorisms on the Meaning of Reality) FACT:
03 1. THEORY OF REALITY FACT:	04 1A. JAINA PRAMĀṆA (means of valid knowledge) SCHEME: THE EPISTEMIC GROUND OF ANEKĀNTAVĀDA (doctrine of many-sided reality) FACT:
05 2. SAPTABHAṆĠĪNAYA (sevenfold standpoint-based judgement) FACT:	06 3. BONDAGE AND LIBERATION FACT:
07 3A. SEVEN TATTVAS (fundamental categories of reality and liberation) AND NINE PADĀRTHAS (ontological categories) FACT:	08 3B. EIGHT KARMA-PRAKṚTIS (types or species of karma) AND THE MECHANICS OF BANDHA (bondage) FACT:
09 3C. FOURTEEN GUṆASTHĀNAS (fourteen stages of spiritual development): STAGES OF SPIRITUAL DEVELOPMENT FACT:	10 3D. SALLEKHANĀ (ritual thinning of passions and body near unavoidable death) / SANTHĀRĀ (vow of disciplined fasting near unavoidable death): DEATH WITHOUT PASSION FACT:
11 4. INTER-THINKER / INTER-SCHOOL DEBATES CAUTION:	12 5. NAMED CRITICISMS AND JAINA REPLIES FACT:
13 6. COMMON UPSC TRAPS FACT:	14 7. KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK FACT:

Read numbered cells left-to-right, then continue on the next row.

BASIC — COMPLETE TEACHING FLOW



Source-complete coverage ledger and answer-worthiness labels

Source corpus	Final location	Retention decision
Layered Simple/Core/Exam/Rapid material	Basic Learning Session	Complete seven-subtopic teaching sequence retained
Layered Advanced material	Optional Advanced	Every advanced synthesis retained after practice
Canonical owner	Reconciled through layered session	Full metaphysics, epistemology, judgement and soteriology ownership retained
Legacy solved workbook	PYQs and Answer Practice	Nine solved PYQs preserved and improved
Premium diagnostic replacement	MCQs / Remediation	Legacy 24+8 set expanded to genuine 40+8 with strict rotation
Original practice	PYQs and Answer Practice	Six solved non-PYQ models replace the legacy three-model set
Consolidated register	Final section	A–L retrieval framework covers all printed syllabus limbs

Answer-worthiness. Theory of reality, *anekāntavāda*, *dravya-guṇa-paryāya*, *saptabhaṅgī*, material karma, bondage and liberation are **CORE SYLLABUS**. The Jaina pramāṇa scheme, seven *nayas*, karma taxonomy and *guṇasthānas* are **CORE SUPPORTING DEPTH** where they explain PYQs. Sectarian minutiae and unverified legal detail are not answer targets.



Contemporary-anchor discipline

FACT: **Fact:** A live August 2026 search primarily returned contemporary educational discussion of *anekāntavāda* and continuing ethical discussion of *sallekhanā*, not a clearly verified new court ruling in the February–August window. CAUTION: **Inference:** Use *anekāntavāda* as a conceptual resource for intellectual humility and *sallekhanā* as a bounded ethics application. Do not invent a fresh legal development or let current application replace the printed metaphysics–logic–liberation syllabus.



Learner-v2 roadmap

MANY-SIDED REALITY
->
PARTIAL FINITE KNOWLEDGE
->
QUALIFIED JUDGEMENT
->
RIGHT VISION, KNOWLEDGE AND CONDUCT
->
STOPPAGE + SHEDDING OF MATERIAL KARMA (action and its morally consequential residue)
->
INDIVIDUAL LIBERATED SIDDHA (liberated perfected soul)



Master distinction gateway		
Doctrine	Level	One-line role
Anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality)	metaphysics	reality has many objective aspects
Nayavāda (theory of partial standpoints)	epistemology	finite knowledge grasps a standpoint
Syādvāda (doctrine of qualified or conditional assertion)	semantics	assertions require conditional qualification
Saptabhaṅgī (sevenfold predication)	formal expansion	seven combinations of affirmation, negation and inexpressibility

Master verdict: Jainism is pluralistic realism with epistemic non-absolutism and a material theory of karmic bondage; its unity lies in linking ontology, knowledge, conduct and liberation.



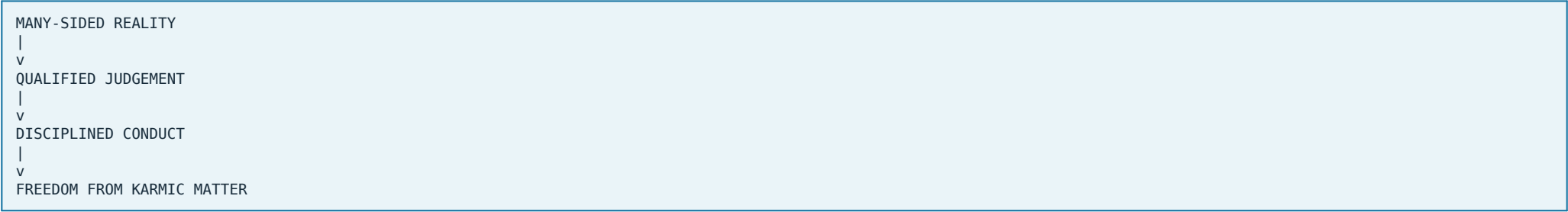
How to use this layered session	
Every logical subtopic follows the Philosophy five-layer sequence:	
Layer	Purpose
1. SIMPLE START	Plain-language visual gateway
2. CORE UPSC	Complete retained doctrine, terminology, arguments and examples
3. ADVANCED	Objections, replies, comparisons and qualified evaluation
4. EXAM APPLICATION	Verified PYQ routing and marks-wise answer structure
5. RAPID REVISION	Traps, recall spines and mastery preparation

Source audit: the repository Jainism knowledge file and complete 2018-2025 PYQ bank were checked; local OCR-searchable chapters in Chatterjee-Datta and C. D. Sharma were directly inspected. A live 2026 search found contemporary discussion of *anekāntavāda* and *sallekhanā*, used only as labelled conceptual application rather than doctrinal authority. Qdrant was not required.

Preservation note: every substantive section of the previous complete Jainism session is retained below. The new material provides simpler gateways and explicit learning layers without replacing the original depth.



Plain-language visual - the three connected pillars



In simple words: Jainism is one connected philosophical system. Reality contains many genuine aspects; finite knowers see only some of them; statements must therefore be qualified; and right knowledge must transform conduct so that karmic bondage can end.

First anchor	Easy meaning
Tattvārthasūtra (<i>Aphorisms on the Meaning of Reality</i>)	Shared systematic text for the major Jaina traditions
Three jewels	Right vision, right knowledge and right conduct
Tirthaṅkara (liberated ford-maker and teacher)	Liberated teacher and ford-maker, not a creator God
Central movement	Reality -> knowledge -> conduct -> liberation

Memory line: Jainism joins realism, intellectual humility and self-purification.



0. ONE-SCREEN MAP

JAINISM (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation)

- |
- + - SOURCE ANCHOR
 - | +- Tattvārthasūtra (Aphorisms on the Meaning of Reality): ratna-traya (three jewels of right vision, knowledge and conduct), tattvas (fundamental categories of reality and liberation), dravyas (plural form: substance), jñāna (knowledge), liberation
 - |
- + - THEORY OF REALITY
 - | +- Anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) (anekantavada (doctrine of many-sided reality)): reality is many-sided
 - | +- Dravya (substance) = sat (being or reality) = utpāda (origination) + vyaya (cessation or decay) + dhrauvya (persistence)
 - | +- Six dravyas (plural form: substance): jīva (living conscious substance or soul), pudgala (matter capable of combination and disintegration), dharma (doctrine, duty or constitutive factor, as context requires), adharma (non-duty or, in Jainism, the medium enabling rest), ākāśa (space), kāla (time)
 - | +- Pañcāstikāya (five extended substances): five extended substances; kāla (time) is an-astikāya (non-extended substance)
 - | +- Guṇa (quality) (qualities) + paryāya (changing mode) (modes)
 - |
- + - EPISTEMOLOGY
 - | +- Pratyakṣa (perception) vs parokṣa (indirect or mediated knowledge), with the Jaina inversion trap
 - | +- Five jñānas (plural form: knowledge): mati (sense-and-mind cognition), śruta (scriptural or verbal cognition), avadhi (clairvoyant knowledge), manaḥparyāya (direct knowledge of others' mental states), kevala (perfect and unobstructed)
 - | +- Partial kṣāyopasaṃika (arising through partial destruction and suppression of karmic obstruction) knowledge grounds nayavāda (theory of partial standpoints) and syādvāda (doctrine of qualified or conditional assertion)
 - |
- + - THEORY OF JUDGEMENT
 - | +- Nayavāda (theory of partial standpoints): partial standpoints
 - | +- Syādvāda (doctrine of qualified or conditional assertion): conditional predication
 - | +- Saptabhaṅgī (sevenfold predication): sevenfold judgement
 - |
- + - SOTERIOLOGY
 - + - Seven tattvas (fundamental categories of reality and liberation) / nine padārthas (ontological categories)
 - + - Karma (action and its morally consequential residue) = subtle material pudgala (matter capable of combination and disintegration); eight karma-prakṛtis (types or species of karma)
 - + - Āsrava (influx of karmic matter) -> bandha (bondage) -> saṃvara (stoppage of karmic influx) -> nirjarā (shedding of accumulated karma) -> mokṣa (liberation)
 - + - Bhāvabandha (psychic or intentional bondage) + dravyabandha (material karmic bondage); four bandha-parameters
 - + - Guṇasthānas (fourteen stages of spiritual development): fourteen stages, including sayoga-kevalī (omniscient being still engaged in activity)
 - + - Three jewels + vows + sallekhanā (ritual thinning of passions and body near unavoidable death) lead to kevala-jñāna (perfect omniscience) and liberation



0A. UMĀSVĀTĪ / UMĀSVĀMĪ AND THE TATTVĀRTHASŪTRA (Aphorisms on the Meaning of Reality) FACT:

Statement. FACT: The *Tattvārthasūtra* or *Tattvārthādhigama-sūtra* of **Umāsvātī** in Śvetāmbara usage and **Umāsvāmī** in Digambara usage is the first systematic Sanskrit exposition of Jaina philosophy and is authoritative for both major sects.

Argument. FACT:

- FACT: It gives a compact doctrinal grammar for Jaina metaphysics, epistemology, ethics, bondage, and liberation.
- FACT: Its cross-sectarian authority is unusual because Śvetāmbara and Digambara traditions often differ in scriptural canon and practice.
- FACT: It states the path through the **ratna-traya** (three jewels): **samyag-darśana** (right vision), **samyag-jñāna** (right knowledge), and **samyak-cāritra** (right conduct).
- FACT: It systematizes the seven tattvas, the five astikāyas plus kāla, and the classification of jñāna without reducing Jainism to only ethics or only logic.

Presupposition. CAUTION: A UPSC answer improves when Jainism is presented as a systematic darśana rather than as a loose collection of ascetic practices.

Distinction. FACT: The Tirthaṅkaras are liberated teachers and ford-makers, not creator Gods; Jainism remains **anīśvaravāda** (non-theistic about creation).

Example. FACT: The famous formulation that right vision, right knowledge, and right conduct together constitute the path to mokṣa may be safely used without inventing a sūtra number.

Objection (sectarian-history objection). QUESTION: A critic may ask whether a text accepted by both Śvetāmbaras and Digambaras erases real sectarian differences.

Reply. CAUTION: It does not erase them; it supplies a shared doctrinal framework within which disagreements about canon, practice, and interpretation can still remain.

Names to drop carefully. FACT:

- FACT: **Kundakunda**: Digambara thinker associated with *Samayasāra* and the **niścaya-naya / vyavahāra-naya** distinction.
- FACT: **Siddhasena Divākara** and **Samantabhadra**: important names in the early logic of anekānta and syādvāda.
- FACT: **Akalaṅka**, **Māṇikyanandi**, **Hemacandra**, and **Yaśovijaya**: major later Jaina logicians to cite for the mature pramāṇa tradition.



Exam route

- Use this system map as the introduction to any 15- or 20-marker.
- A high-scoring opening states that Jainism is **pluralistic realism with non-absolutist finite predication and a material theory of karmic bondage**.
- Do not spend more than two or three lines on sectarian history unless the question specifically asks for sources.
- The nine verified topic-owned PYQs are solved in the complete practice section and separate workbook.



Rapid recall

- Textual anchor: Umāsvāti / Umāsvāmī and the *Tattvārthasūtra*.
- Path: *samyag-darśana* + *samyag-jñāna* + *samyak-cāritra*.
- No creator God; liberated teachers remain numerically distinct souls.
- Never reduce Jainism to either "seven viewpoints" or "non-violence" alone.



Plain-language visual - permanence without freezing change

GOLD BRACELET
|
| reshaped
v
GOLD RING

gold persists = dhrauvya (persistence)
bracelet-mode ends = vyaya (cessation or decay)
ring-mode begins = utpada

In simple words: a real thing can remain the same substance while its modes change. Jainism refuses both extremes: reality is neither a motionless block nor a series with no enduring identity.

Term	Easy meaning
Dravya (substance)	Enduring substance
Guṇa (quality)	Stable quality belonging to it
Paryāya (changing mode)	Changing mode or condition
Anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality)	A real has many objective aspects
Six dravyas (plural form: substance)	Soul, matter, motion-medium, rest-medium, space and time

Memory line: the substance persists while modes originate and decay.



1. THEORY OF REALITY FACT:

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a pluralist realism in which anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) holds that enduring dravya (substance) possesses guṇa (qualities) and changing paryāya (modes).



1.1 Anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) as metaphysical thesis

Statement. FACT: **Anekāntavāda** is the Jaina doctrine that reality is many-sided; no single unqualified proposition exhausts the nature of a real thing.

Argument. FACT:

- Real things endure through change and exhibit multiple aspects.
- Human cognition usually grasps only one aspect at a time.
- Dogmatic one-sided claims therefore distort reality.
- A sound metaphysics must allow plurality of aspects within one real.
- Hence reality is non-one-sided, or anekānta.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Being is richer than any single finite judgement.

Distinction. FACT: Anekāntavāda is not mere indecision. It is a **metaphysical** claim about the complexity of reality, not yet the logical form of predication.

Example. FACT: A jar is permanent as a substance across a short stretch, changing in modes, describable by shape, use, material, and temporal state. No one predicate says all of this at once.

Objection (skeptical objection). FACT: If every object has indefinitely many aspects, knowledge may become impossible.

Reply. CAUTION: Jaina thought replies that knowledge is possible precisely through qualified standpoints, not through absolutist simplification.



1.2 Dravya (substance) as sat (being or reality) = utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya (origination, decay and persistence) FACT:

Statement. FACT: The real (**sat**) is what possesses **utpāda** (origination), **vyaya** (decay), and **dhrauvya** (persistence or permanence) together.

Argument. FACT:

- Experience shows change: forms arise and pass.
- Experience also shows continuity: something persists through those changes.
- Pure permanence cannot explain transformation.
- Pure flux cannot explain identity.
- Therefore reality must include both persistence and modification.
- This is articulated by saying substance is characterized by origination, decay, and permanence.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Both common-sense identity and experiential change are philosophically significant and must be preserved.

Distinction. FACT: This differs from Buddhist momentariness, which gives primacy to flux, and from strict monisms that absorb change into mere appearance.

Example. FACT: A gold ornament changes from bracelet to ring: modes originate and cease, yet the underlying substance persists.

Objection (Buddhist/Nyāya-style objection). FACT: How can opposite features—change and permanence—belong to one thing?

Reply. FACT: They belong in different respects: permanence as dravya, change as paryāya.



1.3 Six dravyas (plural form: substance) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jainism classically recognizes **six dravyas**: **jīva**, **pudgala**, **dharma**, **adharma**, **ākāśa**, and **kāla**.

Argument. FACT:

- FACT: The classification accounts for consciousness, matter, motion, rest, spatial accommodation, and temporal succession.
- FACT: Jainism is therefore pluralistic without being chaotic: each dravya has a distinct explanatory function.
- FACT: Five of the six dravyas are **astikāyas** (extended substances with many space-points or **pradeśas**).
- FACT: **Kāla** (time) is a real dravya in the mainstream sixfold presentation, but it is **not** an astikāya; hence Jainism speaks of **pañcāstikāya** plus kāla.

The six dravyas. FACT:

Dravya (substance)	Basic sense	Role
Jīva (living conscious substance or soul)	conscious substance	experiencer, knower, bearer of bondage and liberation
Pudgala (matter capable of combination and disintegration)	matter	corporeality, karmic matter, bodies, sense-objects
Dharma (doctrine, duty or constitutive factor, as context requires)	medium of motion	condition making movement possible
Adharma (non-duty or, in Jainism, the medium enabling rest)	medium of rest	condition making rest possible
Ākāśa (space)	space	accommodation for substances
Kāla (time)	time	succession, change, sequence

Astikāya table. FACT:

Dravya (substance)	Astikāya (extended substance occupying spatial points)?	Function	Extension
Jīva (living conscious substance or soul)	FACT: Yes	knowing, experiencing, agency, bondage and liberation	FACT: Has pradeśas (plural form: quantity of karmic particles or spatial points); in embodied existence it is co-extensive with the body
Pudgala (matter capable of combination and disintegration)	FACT: Yes	material bodies, sense-objects, speech, breath, karma-pudgala	FACT: Extended and aggregative
Dharma-dravya (medium enabling motion)	FACT: Yes	medium enabling motion	FACT: Co-extensive with lokākāśa (inhabited cosmic space)
Adharma-dravya (medium enabling rest)	FACT: Yes	medium enabling rest	FACT: Co-extensive with lokākāśa (inhabited cosmic space)

Dravya (substance)	Astikāya (extended substance occupying spatial points)?	Function	Extension
Ākāśa (space)	FACT: Yes	gives room or accommodation to substances	FACT: Extended as lokākāśa (inhabited cosmic space) and alokākāśa (space beyond the inhabited cosmos)
Kāla (time)	□ No	succession, duration, before-and-after, change	FACT: A dravya (substance) but an-astikāya (non-extended substance) because it lacks spatial extension across many pradeśas (plural form: quantity of karmic particles or spatial points) in the astikāya (extended substance occupying spatial points) sense

Presupposition. CAUTION: Reality is irreducibly pluralistic, and extension must be distinguished from substantiality.

Distinction. FACT: **Dharma** and **adharma** here do **not** mean moral merit and demerit; they mean media of motion and rest.

Sectarian note. FACT: The safe doctrinal point is: **kāla is a dravya but not an astikāya**; the pañcāstikāya list has five members, while the dravya list has six. QUESTION: A common sectarian nuance is that Digambara authors characteristically affirm real **kāla-aṇus** (time-atoms) associated with the space-points of lokākāśa, whereas some Śvetāmbara discussions treat the substantial independence of kāla as disputed or conventional.

Example. FACT: A fish swims because water is the medium enabling motion; analogically, dharma-dravya is the cosmic condition enabling movement, not motion itself.

Objection (Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika-style objection). FACT: Dharma and adharma as “media” look mysterious and unparsimonious.

Reply. CAUTION: Jaina metaphysics treats them not as pushes or forces but as enabling conditions required for a coherent pluralistic cosmology.



1.4 Guṇa (quality) and paryāya (changing mode) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Every dravya possesses **guṇa** (essential qualities) and **paryāya** (modes or modifications).

Argument. FACT:

A substance must have stable features or it would not be what it is.

It must also undergo modal change or it would not participate in experience.

Therefore it is intelligible as substance-with-qualities-and-modes.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Ontology must distinguish what remains from how it appears or changes.

Distinction. FACT: **Guṇa** is not the same as **paryāya**: qualities belong to the substance as abiding characteristics; modes are changing states or manifestations.

Example. FACT: Consciousness is a defining feature of jīva; pleasure, pain, delusion, or liberated omniscience are modes or conditions in which the jīva appears.

Objection (Buddhist nominalist objection). FACT: Why not just speak of changing qualities rather than introduce a substance?

Reply. CAUTION: Because changing qualities still presuppose something whose changes they are.



1.5 Jīva (living conscious substance or soul) and ajīva (non-living reality) FACT:

Statement. FACT: The most fundamental ontological distinction is between **jīva** (conscious) and **ajīva** (non-conscious).

Argument. FACT:

- Experience distinguishes living, aware beings from inert entities.
- This distinction is ontologically basic because consciousness cannot be reduced to inert matter in Jaina thought.
- Hence the universe divides into jīva and ajīva.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Consciousness is real and fundamental, not epiphenomenal.

Distinction. FACT: Unlike Advaita, this is not a distinction within one underlying Brahman. Unlike Cārvāka, consciousness is not reducible to material organization.

Example. FACT: The body, speech, and even karmic matter belong to ajīva; the conscious experiencer bound by them is jīva.

Objection (Nyāya-Vedānta objection). FACT: If jīva is immaterial, how can material karma affect it?

Reply. CAUTION: This becomes the central challenge in Jaina bondage theory and is answered through the doctrine of karmic influx and adhesion, though critics find the relation obscure.



1.6 Nature of jīva (living conscious substance or soul) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Every jīva is distinct, beginningless, intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, and power, though these are obscured by karma.

Argument. FACT:

- Liberation is meaningful only if the soul has a native capacity to realize perfection.
- Bondage is then understood as obscuration, not total annihilation of that nature.
- Therefore jīva is intrinsically luminous but contingently covered.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Spiritual progress presupposes a real self capable of purification.

Distinction. FACT: Jainism is pluralistic: there are many jīvas, not one universal self. It also differs from Nyāya, where the self is conscious through conjunction with mind; in Jainism consciousness belongs intrinsically to jīva.

Example. FACT: Souls are graded from one-sense beings to five-sense beings; even minute living entities are morally significant.

Objection (Sāṃkhya/Vedānta objection). FACT: If the soul is naturally omniscient, ignorance becomes hard to explain.

Reply. FACT: Karma as obscuring matter is introduced precisely to explain the discrepancy between intrinsic capacity and empirical limitation.



1.7 Pudgala (matter capable of combination and disintegration) FACT:

Statement. FACT: **Pudgala** is the material dravya and the only dravya possessing **rūpa** (form); it includes atoms, bodies, sense-objects, and karmic matter.

Argument. FACT:

- Corporeality, extension, and sensible quality require a material substrate.
- Matter must therefore be treated as a real and irreducible category.
- Since karmic bondage has quasi-physical efficacy, karmic particles too are classed under pudgala.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Materiality is not illusory; it is an objective domain with its own laws.

Distinction. FACT: Pudgala is uniquely important because unlike jīva it is divisible, aggregative, and form-bearing.

Example. FACT: The body I inhabit, the food I consume, the dust in air, and karmic accretions all belong to pudgala.

Objection (Nyāya/Mīmāṃsā-style objection). FACT: To call karma matter seems strange.

Reply. FACT: That strangeness is also Jainism's originality: bondage is not merely moral description but a real quasi-physical entanglement.



Exam route

2019, Q6(a), 20 marks: define reality through *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauṇya*, explain *dravya-guṇa-paryāya*, then show how this ontology requires qualified judgement.

2025, Q7(c), 15 marks: establish realism through mind-independent substances and pluralism through the six *dravyas* and many individual souls; then evaluate objections.

For comparison answers, use one axis at a time: permanence/change, number of ultimate realities, status of difference, self, and liberation.



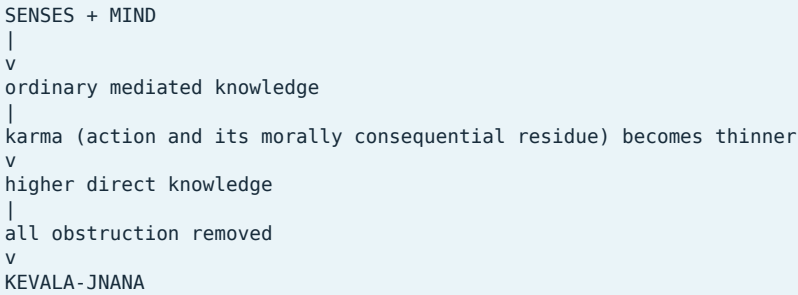
Rapid recall

- *Sat* = origination + decay + permanence.
- Six *dravyas*; five are *astikāyas*, while *kāla* is a dravya but not an *astikāya*.
- *Dharma* and *adharma* mean media of motion and rest, not merit and sin.
- *Jīva* is intrinsically conscious; *pudgala* alone possesses form and includes karmic matter.

• Trap: many-sided reality is objective pluralism, not subjective relativism.



Plain-language visual - why ordinary seeing is not the highest direct knowledge



In simple words: Jainism calls the soul's unmediated cognition truly direct. Ordinary perception depends on senses and mind, so it is direct only in everyday usage. As karmic obstruction decreases, wider forms of knowledge become possible.

Knowledge	Simple role
<i>Mati (sense-and-mind cognition)</i>	Sense-and-mind cognition
<i>Śruta (scriptural or verbal cognition)</i>	Verbal or scriptural cognition
<i>Avadhi (clairvoyant knowledge)</i>	Limited direct knowledge beyond ordinary senses
<i>Manaḥparyāya (direct knowledge of others' mental states)</i>	Direct cognition of mental states
<i>Kevala (perfect and unobstructed)</i>	Complete unobstructed knowledge

Memory line: knowledge is intrinsic to the soul but limited by karmic obstruction.



1A. JAINA PRAMĀṆA (means of valid knowledge) SCHEME: THE EPISTEMIC GROUND OF ANEKĀNTAVĀDA (doctrine of many-sided reality) FACT:



1A.1 Primary division: pratyakṣa (perception) and parokṣa (indirect or mediated knowledge) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jaina epistemology distinguishes **pratyakṣa** (direct knowledge) and **parokṣa** (indirect knowledge), but it uses the word pratyakṣa in a high-yield, non-ordinary way.

Argument. FACT:

- FACT: In the strict Jaina sense, **pratyakṣa** means knowledge that the soul knows directly without mediation by senses or mind.
- FACT: Ordinary sense-perception is therefore not ultimate direct knowledge; it is only **sāṃvṃyavahārika pratyakṣa** (empirical or conventional direct knowledge).

• FACT: Strictly, ordinary sense-and-mind cognition belongs with mediated cognition because it depends on sense-organs, mind, signs, and karmic limitation.
• CAUTION: This reverses the usual classroom expectation that perception is the primary direct pramāṇa.
Presupposition. CAUTION: Directness is measured by freedom from mediation and karmic obstruction, not merely by sensory vividness.
Distinction. FACT: Do not map Jaina pratyakṣa mechanically onto Nyāya pratyakṣa; the same term carries a different doctrinal weight.
Example. FACT: Seeing a pot with the eyes is conventionally direct in ordinary dealings, but kevala-jñāna is direct in the strict spiritual sense.
Objection (Nyāya objection). FACT: Nyāya may object that perception through sense-contact is the paradigm of direct cognition.
Reply. CAUTION: Jainism replies that sense-contact is direct only pragmatically; metaphysically it is mediated by organs, mind, and knowledge-obscuring karma.



1A.2 Five kinds of jñāna (knowledge) FACT:			
Statement. FACT: Jainism classically enumerates five kinds of jñāna (knowledge): mati , śruta , avadhi , manaḥparyāya , and kevala .			
Jñāna (knowledge)	Status	Meaning	UPSC trap
Mati-jñāna	FACT: Parokṣa (indirect or mediated knowledge) / conventional	sense-and-mind cognition	FACT: Ordinary perception is not strict pratyakṣa (perception)
Śruta-jñāna	FACT: Parokṣa (indirect or mediated knowledge)	scriptural, verbal, or sign-mediated knowledge derived from mati (sense-and-mind cognition)	FACT: Not blind faith; it depends on cognition and communication
Avadhi-jñāna	FACT: Mukhya or pāramārthika pratyakṣa (ultimately direct unmediated cognition)	limited clairvoyant direct knowledge of material things	FACT: Direct but limited
Manaḥparyāya-jñāna	FACT: Mukhya or pāramārthika pratyakṣa (ultimately direct unmediated cognition)	direct knowledge of others' mental modes	FACT: Higher than avadhi (clairvoyant knowledge), still not omniscience
Kevala-jñāna (perfect omniscience)	FACT: Mukhya or pāramārthika pratyakṣa (ultimately direct unmediated cognition)	unlimited, unmediated omniscience	FACT: The full overcoming of cognitive obstruction
Argument. FACT:			
• FACT: Mati and śruta are mediated and therefore indirect in the strict classification.			
• FACT: Avadhi, manaḥparyāya, and kevala are direct because the soul knows without ordinary sense-and-mind mediation.			
• FACT: The series shows graded release from karmic veiling.			
Presupposition. CAUTION: Knowledge is graded according to the degree to which karmic obscuration is removed.			
Distinction. FACT: The five jñānas are not five independent pramāṇas in the Nyāya sense; they are Jaina modes of knowledge mapped to bondage and purification.			
Example. FACT: A student's study of doctrine uses mati and śruta; the kevalin's omniscience is immediate and total.			

Objection (Cārvāka-style objection). FACT: Avadhi, manaḥparyāya, and kevala appear unverifiable to ordinary experience.

Reply. CAUTION: Jainism treats them as necessary consequences of its soul-karma theory; a critic may still reject them if the ontology of jīva and karmic obstruction is denied.



1A.3 Wrong cognition: ajñāna (wrong cognition or ignorance) under mithyā-darśana (wrong or deluded worldview) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jainism recognizes **mati-ajñāna** or **kumati**, **śruta-ajñāna** or **kuśruta**, and **vibhaṅga-jñāna** as wrong cognition.

Argument. FACT:

- FACT: Wrongness is not always the mere absence of content.
- FACT: Cognition becomes spiritually wrong when held under **mithyā-darśana** (false vision or wrong orientation).
- FACT: **Kumati** is misoriented sensory-mental cognition; **kuśruta** is misoriented verbal or scriptural cognition; **vibhaṅga-jñāna** is perverted avadhi.
- CAUTION: The content may have some descriptive accuracy, but its orientation is false because it is governed by delusion.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Epistemology and ethics interpenetrate: how one is disposed affects how one knows.

Distinction. FACT: Jaina error is not only logical mistake; it can be a karmically conditioned mode of seeing.

Example. FACT: A learned person may quote doctrine but use it for pride, sectarian contempt, or violence; the verbal cognition then functions as kuśruta.

Objection (Nyāya objection). FACT: Calling cognition wrong because of spiritual orientation seems to confuse truth with moral psychology.

Reply. CAUTION: Jainism replies that bondage affects the knower as a whole; epistemic correctness without right vision remains incomplete for liberation.



1A.4 Later Jaina logic and indirect pramāṇas (plural form: means of valid knowledge) CAUTION:

Statement. FACT: Jainism admits **anumāna** (inference) and **śabda** (testimony or verbal authority) within parokṣa, and later Jaina logicians give a richer account of indirect knowledge.

Argument. CAUTION:

- FACT: **Akalaṅka**, **Māṇikyanandi**, **Hemacandra**, and **Yaśovijaya** are important names for the developed Jaina pramāṇa tradition.
- CAUTION: Later Jaina logicians accept **smṛti** (recollection), **pratyabhijñā** (recognition), **tarka** or **ūha** (reasoning that grasps pervasion or vyāpti), and **anumāna** as valid indirect knowledge in appropriate contexts.
- FACT: This is a notable contrast with Nyāya, which does not treat memory as an independent pramāṇa.
- CAUTION: The Jaina move protects continuity, recognition, and inferential preparation as genuine cognitive achievements without making them omniscient knowledge.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Valid cognition need not be restricted to fresh sense-contact; mediated cognition can still disclose real features of the object.

Distinction. FACT: **Śabda** is accepted as mediated knowledge, not as a creator-God's revelation; Jainism remains non-theistic about cosmic creation.

Example. FACT: Recognizing "this is the same teacher I met earlier" is not mere raw perception; it involves memory and recognition.

Objection (Nyāya objection). FACT: Nyāya can argue that memory merely reproduces past knowledge and is not a new pramāṇa.

Reply. CAUTION: The Jaina reply is that recollection and recognition can be valid cognition when they successfully connect present awareness with a real object or past experience.



1A.5 Critical link: pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge) -> nayavāda (theory of partial standpoints) -> syādvāda (doctrine of qualified or conditional assertion) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Anekāntavāda is not an arbitrary logical device; it is the epistemological consequence of Jaina metaphysics plus Jaina theory of knowledge.

Argument. FACT:

- FACT: Reality is **ananta-dharmātmakaṃ vastu**: the real object has infinitely many aspects, properties, and modes.
- FACT: Ordinary human cognition is **kṣāyopaśamika** (arising from partial destruction-cum-subsidence of knowledge-obscuring karma), and is therefore necessarily partial.
- FACT: A judgment made by a non-omniscient knower captures an aspect, not the whole object.
- FACT: A partial judgment is true only relative to its standpoint; this is **nayavāda**.
- FACT: Absolutising a partial standpoint yields **ekāntavāda** (one-sidedness), the root error of rival schools according to Jainism.
- FACT: Therefore assertion must carry the operator **syāt** ("from a certain standpoint"); this is **syādvāda**.
- FACT: The sevenfold schema of qualified predication is the disciplined expression of that standpoint-relativity; this is **saptabhaṅgī**.
- FACT: Only **kevala-jñāna** grasps all aspects at once, because only omniscience is no longer karmically partial.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Finite cognition is not false simply because it is partial; it becomes false when it claims unconditioned finality.

Distinction. FACT: Jaina relativity is not subjectivism: the aspects are really in the object, but finite knowers access them partially.

Example. FACT: "The jar exists" is true with respect to its present substance-mode-place-time complex, but false with respect to another place, another time, or another incompatible mode.

Objection (Śaṅkara-style objection). FACT: If all assertions are standpoint-relative, the assertion of standpoint-relativity may also lose absolute force.

Reply. CAUTION: Jainism accepts reflexive qualification: syādvāda too is asserted **syāt**, and its force lies in disciplined anti-absolutism rather than in an unqualified dogma.



Exam route

The epistemology is essential to the **2023, Q5(a), 10 marks** quotation on empirical and relative knowledge. Test the quotation rather than accepting it: ordinary embodied cognition is relative, but Jainism admits non-sensory direct knowledge and *kevala-jñāna*.

In a 15-marker, move through: classification of knowledge -> karmic limitation -> partial standpoints -> conditional predication -> omniscience qualification -> critical burden.



Rapid recall

- Strict Jaina *pratyakṣa* is soul-direct, not ordinary sense perception.
- *Mati* and *śruta* are ordinary mediated cognition.
- *Avadhi*, *manaḥparyāya* and *kevala* are increasingly direct.
- Partial knowledge explains *naya*; it does not make external reality subjective.
- Trap: "all Jaina knowledge is empirical and relative" is false because of *kevala-jñāna*.



Plain-language visual - one object, several valid questions

CLAY JAR
/ | \
material? place? time?
clay here present now

"It exists" is incomplete until the respect is stated.

In simple words: the same jar can exist here, fail to exist elsewhere, persist as clay, and change as a particular shape. Jainism asks us to attach the hidden condition to every claim rather than turning one partial truth into the whole truth.

Doctrine	Job
<i>Anekāntavāda</i> (doctrine of many-sided reality)	Reality has many aspects
<i>Nayavāda</i> (theory of partial standpoints)	A judgement selects a partial standpoint
<i>Syādvāda</i> (doctrine of qualified or conditional assertion)	The assertion is explicitly qualified
<i>Saptabhaṅgī</i> (sevenfold predication)	Seven ordered combinations of is, is-not and inexpressible

Memory line: many-sided object -> partial standpoint -> conditional sentence -> sevenfold expansion.



2. SAPTABHAṆGĪNAYA (sevenfold standpoint-based judgement) FACT:

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Saptabhaṅgī (sevenfold predication) expresses syādvāda (doctrine of conditional assertion) by qualifying every judgement through a standpoint, thereby avoiding both dogmatic absolutism and sceptical silence.



2.1 Nayavāda (theory of partial standpoints): standpoint-theory

Statement. FACT: **Nayavāda** teaches that every ordinary judgement expresses a **naya**, a standpoint that captures one aspect of the real.

Argument. FACT:

- Reality is many-sided.
- Finite knowers rarely grasp all sides at once.
- Therefore judgements are aspectual, not exhaustive.
- A doctrine of standpoints is needed to explain how partial truth is possible.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Partiality is not falsehood; it becomes falsehood only when the partial is absolutized.

Distinction. FACT: Nayavāda is not skepticism. It permits truth, but qualified truth.

Example. FACT: A jar may be described as clay, as container, as round, as breakable, as existing-now. Each statement is true from a standpoint.

Objection (Nyāya-style objection). FACT: Standpoints may proliferate without limit.

Reply. CAUTION: Jaina thinkers classify principal standpoints to discipline rather than dissolve discourse.



2.2 The seven nayas (partial standpoints) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Classical Jainism enumerates seven nayas , each marking a characteristic standpoint.	
Naya (partial standpoint)	Brief meaning
Naigama naya (partial standpoint)	common or teleological standpoint; mixed, unspecialized practical view
Samgraha naya (partial standpoint)	generic standpoint; emphasis on class-character
Vyavahāra naya (partial standpoint)	practical or particular standpoint; ordinary usage about specific things
Rjusūtra naya (partial standpoint)	momentary or present-state standpoint
Śabda (verbal testimony) naya (partial standpoint)	verbal standpoint; attention to linguistic expression
Samabhirūḍha naya (partial standpoint)	etymological or strictly differentiated verbal standpoint
Evambhūta naya (partial standpoint)	actuality-conditioned verbal standpoint; a term applies when the function is being performed

Argument. FACT: The list shows that partiality may arise from pragmatic, generic, particular, temporal, and linguistic conditioning.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Language itself contributes to one-sidedness if its scope is not critically examined.

Distinction. FACT: Do not confuse **nayas** (standpoints) with the **sevenfold predications** of *syādvāda*. The former are epistemic perspectives; the latter are structured propositional forms.

Example. FACT: Calling a person “a singer” may be true generically or dispositionally, but **evambhūta naya** is stricter: the term applies in the relevant performance-actuality.

Objection (examiner's objection). FACT: The linguistic *nayas* seem overly scholastic.

Reply. CAUTION: They matter because many philosophical disputes are verbal absolutizations of context-bound usage.



2.3 *Syādvāda* (doctrine of qualified or conditional assertion) as logical expression

Statement. FACT: **Syādvāda** is the doctrine that assertions should be made with the qualification **syāt**—“in some respect,” “from a certain standpoint,” or “conditionally.”

Argument. FACT:

- Since reality is many-sided, categorical assertion is risky.
- Since judgements arise from standpoints, language must register conditionality.
- The particle **syāt** prevents absolutization.
- Hence *syādvāda* is the logical-linguistic expression of *anekāntavāda*.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Good logic mirrors ontological complexity and epistemic modesty.

Distinction. FACT: *Anekāntavāda* = metaphysical doctrine; *nayavāda* = theory of standpoints; *syādvāda* = mode of conditional predication.

Example. FACT: “The jar exists” becomes “*syād asti*”—it exists in some respect, e.g., as present on the floor now.

Objection (Śaṃkara-style objection). FACT: Constant qualification may weaken assertoric force.

Reply. CAUTION: Jaina logic accepts that precision is preferable to dogmatic simplicity.



2.4 *Saptabhaṅgī* (sevenfold predication): the seven predications, exactly and in order FACT:

Statement. FACT: The **saptabhaṅgī** is the sevenfold schema of conditional predication produced by combining affirmation, negation, and indescribability under the qualifier **syāt**.

- **syād asti** — in some respect, it is.
- **syād nāsti** — in some respect, it is not.

• syād asti ca nāsti ca — in some respect, it is and it is not.
• syād avaktavyam — in some respect, it is indescribable.
• syād asti ca avaktavyam — in some respect, it is and is indescribable.
• syād nāsti ca avaktavyam — in some respect, it is not and is indescribable.
• syād asti ca nāsti ca avaktavyam — in some respect, it is, is not, and is indescribable.
Argument. FACT:
• A thing may be affirmed under one standpoint.
• Negated under another.
• Both affirmed and negated under different references or times.
• Called indescribable where simultaneous exhaustive predication fails.
• Combinations of these yield seven basic structured forms.
Presupposition. CAUTION: Contraries need not violate logic when they are indexed to standpoint, time, relation, or mode.
Distinction. FACT: “Indescribable” does not mean mystical silence simpliciter. It means that an unqualified or simultaneous statement is not straightforwardly expressible.
Example. FACT: A clay jar exists now on the table; it does not exist as a lump of raw clay; it both is and is not under different modal descriptions; in a complex state of transition it may be called avaktavya.
Objection (Śaṃkara/Rāmānuja objection). FACT: Critics say this violates non-contradiction.
Reply. FACT: The Jaina response is that contradiction would arise only if affirmation and negation were made in the same respect at the same time in the same sense. Syāt blocks that absolutist reading.



2.5 Blind men and the elephant FACT:
Statement. FACT: The familiar illustration of the blind men and the elephant captures the spirit of anekāntavāda: each grasped part yields a partial truth wrongly elevated into a whole truth.
Argument. CAUTION: The illustration dramatizes the difference between partial correctness and exclusive completeness .
Presupposition. CAUTION: Cognitive violence begins when a part is mistaken for the whole.
Distinction. FACT: The parable illustrates non-absolutism; it is not itself the formal doctrine.
Example. FACT: One touches the trunk and says “the elephant is like a serpent,” another the leg and says “like a pillar.” Each is conditionally right and absolutely wrong.
Objection (pedagogical objection). FACT: The parable may trivialize complex metaphysics.

Reply. CAUTION: It is pedagogical, not probative; its use is to clarify the structure of partial truth.



2.6 Five kinds of knowledge FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jaina epistemology commonly speaks of **five kinds of knowledge**: **mati**, **śruta**, **avadhi**, **manaḥparyāya**, and **kevala**.

Kind of knowledge	Basic sense
Mati-jñāna	sensory-mental cognition, ordinary empirical knowledge
Śruta-jñāna	scriptural/verbal knowledge, mediated through signs and teaching
Avadhi-jñāna	clairvoyant knowledge of material things beyond ordinary sense range
Manahparyāya-jñāna	telepathic knowledge of mental states
Kevala-jñāna (perfect omniscience)	perfect omniscience

Argument. FACT: The gradation maps the progressive removal of karmic obstruction from cognition.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Knowledge is not uniform; it has degrees according to the soul’s purity.

Distinction. FACT: In exam answers, do not confuse these five kinds of knowledge with the seven nayas or the sevenfold predications.

Example. FACT: The ordinary learner begins with mati and śruta, while the liberated or near-liberated soul culminates in kevala-jñāna.

Objection (Cārvāka-style objection). FACT: Higher forms seem unverifiable.

Reply. CAUTION: Within Jainism they are internally connected to the ontology of soul and karma; externally they remain open to critical challenge.



2.7 Standard objection: is anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) self-refuting or trivial? FACT:

Statement. FACT: Critics argue either that anekāntavāda is self-refuting—because the claim that “all reality is many-sided” is itself made absolutely—or trivial, because everyone already admits contextual variation.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

- If every assertion must be qualified, then the doctrine itself must be qualified.
- If qualified, it may lose universal force.
- If unqualified, it violates its own rule.
- Alternatively, if it merely says that things can be looked at in different ways, it seems philosophically thin.

Presupposition. CAUTION: A doctrine of relativity must explain its own status.

Reply. FACT:

- Jainism need not deny that the doctrine itself is also expressible from a standpoint.
- This does not collapse it; it exhibits the very discipline it teaches.
- The thesis is not that all statements are equally true, but that truth is aspect-conditioned.
- Its philosophical bite lies in reconciling plurality with realism, not in banal relativism.



2.8 Does Jaina non-absolutism presuppose absolutism? (2022) CAUTION:

Statement. CAUTION: A standard challenge says that to say reality is many-sided, one must already know absolutely that it is so; therefore anekāntavāda covertly presupposes absolutism.

Argument of the challenge. FACT:

- The doctrine claims universal scope.
- Universal scope appears absolute.
- Therefore the doctrine seems to rely on the very absolutism it criticizes.

Jaina reply. FACT:

- Non-absolutism does not deny more comprehensive knowledge; it denies one-sided exclusivism by finite knowers.
- The doctrine is a methodological and ontological caution against ekānta, not a ban on all graded comprehensiveness.
- Within Jainism, **kevala-jñāna** represents total knowledge, while ordinary discourse remains standpoint-bound.
- Hence the charge succeeds only if one confuses finite judgement with omniscient cognition.

Assessment. CAUTION: This is a subtle and strong reply: Jainism can admit a difference between omniscience and ordinary language without abandoning its critique of dogmatic partiality.



2.9 Is Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation) pluralistic and realistic? (2025) CAUTION:

Statement. CAUTION: Yes, Jainism is strongly **pluralistic** and broadly **realistic**, though both labels require nuance.

Why pluralistic. FACT:

- It accepts many real souls.
- It accepts multiple irreducible dravyas.

- It rejects monistic reduction.

- Liberation is of many individual souls, not absorption into one absolute.

Why realistic. FACT:

- It treats dravyas, qualities, and modes as objectively real.

- The external world is not illusion.

- Knowledge aims at real objects, though only under standpoints.

Nuance. CAUTION: Its realism is **qualified realism**, because judgement is standpoint-indexed. But qualification of knowledge does not imply unreality of the object.

Objection (realist objection). FACT: If all knowledge is relative to standpoint, realism weakens.

Reply. CAUTION: Jainism separates ontological realism from epistemic non-absolutism: reality is objective, but our finite access to it is partial.



Exam route

2021, Q7(c), 15 marks: define the doctrinal chain, list all seven predicates in order, apply one jar example, block the contradiction objection, and conclude that this is disciplined conditional predication.

2022, Q6(b), 15 marks: reconstruct the absolutism objection fairly, distinguish non-absolutism from sceptical relativism, use *kevala-jñāna* as the Jaina reply, and concede the residual burden.

2023, Q5(a), 10 marks: qualify the quotation "all human knowledge is empirical and relative" using the fivefold knowledge scheme.



Rapid recall

- Seven *nayas* are standpoint disciplines; seven *bhaṅgas* are predicative forms.

- *Syāt* means "in some respect", not "perhaps" or mere probability.

- Third form asserts is-and-is-not successively or under different qualifications.

- *Avaktavya* marks the limit of one simple utterance, not total unknowability.

- Trap: the blind-men-and-elephant story illustrates partiality, not equality of all opinions.



Plain-language visual - the dust and wet-cloth model

PASSION + ACTIVITY
|
v
soul becomes "sticky" = bhavabandha
|
karmic matter flows in = asrava (influx of karmic matter)
|
particles bind = dravyabandha (material karmic bondage)
|
stop new + shed old = samvara (stoppage of karmic influx) + nirjara (shedding of accumulated karma)
|
LIBERATED INDIVIDUAL SOUL = moksa (liberation)

In simple words: anger, pride, deceit and greed create the inner condition for bondage. Subtle karmic matter then attaches to the soul and obscures its natural knowledge. Liberation removes the obstruction; it does not create a new soul.

Core term	Easy meaning
Āsrava (influx of karmic matter)	Influx of karmic matter
Bandha (bondage)	Binding
Samvara (stoppage of karmic influx)	Stopping new influx
Nirjarā (shedding of accumulated karma)	Shedding old karma (action and its morally consequential residue)
Mokṣa (liberation)	Complete freedom with individuality retained

Memory line: inner passion causes material bondage; restraint stops it and discipline removes it.



3. BONDAGE AND LIBERATION FACT:

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jaina bondage begins when āsrava (influx) brings karmic matter into the soul and bandha (bondage) binds it; samvara (stoppage) and nirjarā (shedding) culminate in mokṣa (liberation).



3.1 Karma (action and its morally consequential residue) as subtle material substance

Statement. FACT: Jainism’s distinctive doctrine is that **karma is a subtle material substance**, a form of **pudgala** that flows toward and binds the soul.

Argument. FACT:

- The soul’s intrinsic omniscience is obscured in empirical life.
- This obscuration requires a real binding factor.
- That factor is karma, conceived not merely as moral tendency but as fine material accretion.

- Thus bondage is ontologically real, not merely metaphorical.
- Presupposition.** CAUTION: Ethical and cognitive defilement must have a concrete causal structure.
- Distinction.** FACT: This is a crucial UPSC trap: in Jainism karma is **material**, unlike many Hindu presentations where karma is a moral force, merit-demerit ledger, or adr̥ṣṭa.
- Example.** FACT: Passions attract karmic particles just as a sticky surface gathers dust.
- Objection (Nyāya-Vedānta objection).** FACT: How can matter bind a conscious immaterial soul?
- Reply.** CAUTION: Jainism answers through intimate association and obscuration, though critics often say the mechanism remains conceptually difficult.



3.2 The fivefold soteriological sequence FACT:

Statement. FACT: The Jaina path is commonly described through the sequence āsrava -> bandha -> saṃvara -> nirjarā -> mokṣa.

Stage	Meaning
Āsrava (influx of karmic matter)	influx of karmic matter into the soul
Bandha (bondage)	bondage; karmic matter adheres to the soul
Saṃvara (stoppage of karmic influx)	stoppage of fresh inflow
Nirjarā (shedding of accumulated karma)	shedding or exhaustion of accumulated karma (action and its morally consequential residue)
Mokṣa (liberation)	complete release from karma (action and its morally consequential residue)

- Argument.** FACT:
- Wrong belief, passions, and activity open the soul to karmic influx.
 - Influx produces bondage.
 - Discipline blocks new inflow.
 - Austerity and purification burn off old karma.
 - When all karmic matter is gone, liberation occurs.
- Presupposition.** CAUTION: Spiritual progress is both preventive and purgative.
- Distinction.** FACT: Saṃvara and nirjarā are not the same: one stops new karma; the other removes old karma.
- Example.** FACT: Closing a muddy stream into a tank is like saṃvara; cleaning the sediment already deposited is like nirjarā.

Objection (Buddhist/Vedānta-style objection). FACT: The process may seem mechanically moralistic.

Reply. CAUTION: Its strength is exactly its causal clarity: vice has ontological consequence; discipline has ontological remedy.



3.3 Bhāvabandha (psychic or intentional bondage) and dravyabandha (material karmic bondage) (2024) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Bondage has two closely related forms: **bhāvabandha** (psychic bondage) and **dravyabandha** (material bondage).

Argument. FACT:

- The soul first undergoes affective-volitional corruption through passions, attachment, aversion, delusion, and wrong disposition.
- This inner deformation is **bhāvabandha**.
- Corresponding karmic particles then attach materially to the soul.
- This actual material adhesion is **dravyabandha**.
- Thus psychic and material bondage are distinct yet interlinked.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Inner states are causally efficacious; moral psychology precedes material karmic accretion.

Distinction. FACT:

- **Bhāvabandha** = subjective, intentional, affective bondage.
- **Dravyabandha** = objective, material bondage by karmic pudgala.

Example. FACT: Anger or greed in the soul is bhāvabandha; the karmic matter drawn and fixed by that passion is dravyabandha.

Objection (analytical objection). FACT: Why not collapse them into one process?

Reply. FACT: The distinction helps Jainism explain both moral agency and ontological consequence: one is the soul’s state, the other is the karmic material result.



3.4 The three jewels FACT:

Statement. FACT: Liberation requires the **three jewels (ratnatraya)**: **samyag-darśana** (right faith/vision), **samyag-jñāna** (right knowledge), and **samyag-cāritra** (right conduct).

Argument. FACT:

- One must first see reality correctly.
- One must know it correctly.

• One must live in accordance with that insight.
• Mere knowledge without conduct does not stop karmic influx.
• Mere conduct without right view lacks orientation.
Presupposition. CAUTION: Cognitive, affective, and practical transformation are inseparable.
Distinction. FACT: The three jewels are not sequential in a crude external sense; they are mutually reinforcing dimensions of one path.
Example. FACT: One who knows non-violence conceptually but continues harmful conduct has not completed the path.
Objection (Cārvāka-style objection). FACT: Is “faith” here blind belief?
Reply. FACT: No. Samyag-darśana is right apprehension or trustful orientation to truth, not irrational fideism.



3.5 Five mahāvratas (five great ascetic vows) FACT:		
Statement. FACT: Right conduct is classically articulated through the five mahāvratas: ahimsā, satya, asteya, brahmacarya, and aparigraha.		
Argument. FACT: These vows reduce passions, prevent harmful activity, and therefore check karmic influx.		
Vow	Basic meaning	Soteriological relevance
Ahiṃsā (non-violence)	non-violence	central because injury binds karma (action and its morally consequential residue) deeply
Satya	truthfulness	purifies speech and intention
Asteya	non-stealing	curbs acquisitive harm
Brahmacarya	chastity / control of sensuality	disciplines desire
Aparigraha	non-possession / non-attachment	reduces grasping and karmic adhesion
Presupposition. CAUTION: Ethical discipline is metaphysically effective, not merely socially good.		
Distinction. FACT: In Jainism ahimsā is not only a moral ideal but a central soteriological technology.		
Example. FACT: Extreme care toward even one-sense beings follows from the pluralistic doctrine of jīva.		
Objection (householder-pragmatic objection). FACT: Such rigor seems too severe for ordinary life.		
Reply. CAUTION: Jainism distinguishes full vows for ascetics and limited observances for householders, preserving the ideal while allowing graded practice.		



3.6 Kevala-jñāna (perfect omniscience) FACT:

Statement. FACT: **Kevala-jñāna** is perfect knowledge or omniscience attained when the obstructive karmas are fully destroyed.

Argument. FACT:

- The soul is intrinsically omniscient.
- Ignorance is due to karmic obstruction.
- Remove the obstruction and the native luminosity manifests completely.
- Therefore kevala-jñāna is revelation of what the soul truly is.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Perfection is recovery, not production ex nihilo.

Distinction. FACT: Kevala-jñāna differs from scriptural knowledge and extraordinary clairvoyance; it is total, direct, unobstructed knowledge.

Example. FACT: The Tīrthaṅkara is revered as one who attained such perfect knowledge.

Objection (Buddhist/Cārvāka objection). FACT: Omniscience seems excessive or unverifiable.

Reply. CAUTION: Within Jaina metaphysics, omniscience is the natural terminus of complete karmic purification.



3.7 Mokṣa (liberation) FACT:

Statement. FACT: **Mokṣa** is the final state in which the soul is freed from all karmic matter, regains infinite knowledge, bliss, power, and perception, and rises to **siddha-śīlā**.

Argument. FACT:

- Bondage is due to karmic accretion.
- Complete stoppage and exhaustion of karma eliminate bondage.
- The soul then manifests its intrinsic excellences unobstructed.
- Being no longer weighed down by karmic matter, it rises to the topmost region of the cosmos.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Liberation is individual and cosmologically locatable within the Jaina universe.

Distinction. FACT: Unlike Advaita mokṣa, this is not merger into impersonal Brahman. Unlike Buddhist nirvāṇa, it is liberation of a distinct enduring jīva.

Example. FACT: The liberated soul is a **siddha**, no longer embodied, no longer karmically entangled.

Objection (modern philosophical objection). FACT: Spatial ascent of a liberated soul may seem mythic.

Reply. CAUTION: In doctrinal exposition, one should report the cosmological picture faithfully while separating canonical doctrine from modern philosophical evaluation.



3A. SEVEN TATTVAS (fundamental categories of reality and liberation) AND NINE PADĀRTHAS (ontological categories) FACT:



3A.1 Seven tattvas (fundamental categories of reality and liberation) FACT:

Statement. FACT: The seven tattvas (real categories for liberation-analysis) are jīva , ajīva , āsrava , bandha , saṃvara , nirjarā , and mokṣa .
Argument. FACT:
• FACT: Jīva and ajīva identify the two broad ontological poles.
• FACT: Āsrava explains how karmic matter flows toward the soul.
• FACT: Bandha explains how that matter becomes bound.
• FACT: Samvara explains the stopping of new influx.
• FACT: Nirjarā explains the shedding or wearing away of accumulated karma.
• FACT: Mokṣa names the final state when all karmic bondage is absent.
Presupposition. CAUTION: Metaphysics is organized around soteriology: the list is not merely classificatory but therapeutic.
Distinction. FACT: The tattva-list moves from what exists to what binds and what liberates.
Example. FACT: A person’s anger is not merely a mental event; it opens āsrava, deepens bandha, and must be countered by saṃvara and nirjarā.
Objection (Buddhist-style objection). FACT: The list seems to reify a permanent soul and material karma beyond observable process.
Reply. CAUTION: Jainism replies that without jīva and karma-pudgala, bondage and liberation cannot be explained as real transformation of an enduring knower.



3A.2 Nine padārthas (ontological categories) FACT:

Statement. FACT: The nine padārthas are the same seven tattvas plus puṇya (merit) and pāpa (demerit).		
Enumeration	Members	Exam significance
Seven tattvas (fundamental categories of reality and liberation)	FACT: jīva (living conscious substance or soul), ajīva (non-living reality), āsrava (influx of karmic matter), bandha (bondage), saṃvara (stoppage of karmic influx), nirjarā (shedding of accumulated karma), mokṣa (liberation)	FACT: Standard liberation-sequence framework
Nine padārthas (ontological categories)	FACT: the seven plus puṇya (merit) and pāpa (demerit)	FACT: Makes moral valence explicit
Argument. FACT:		

• FACT: Puṇya and pāpa are ethically important because meritorious and demeritorious states affect karmic bondage.
• CAUTION: They can also be subsumed under āsrava and bandha because both merit and demerit are forms of karmic involvement.
• CAUTION: Hence some expositions emphasize seven for soteriological mechanics and nine for moral classification.
Presupposition. CAUTION: Even “good” karma remains karmic bondage if it keeps the soul within saṃsāra.
Distinction. FACT: Puṇya is better than pāpa ethically, but both are to be transcended for mokṣa.
Example. FACT: Charity performed with attachment may produce puṇya, but liberation requires non-attachment rather than pleasant rebirth alone.
Objection (Mīmāṃsā-style objection). FACT: If puṇya is morally valuable, why treat it as ultimately part of bondage?
Reply. CAUTION: Jainism distinguishes ethical improvement within saṃsāra from final release beyond all karmic determination.



3A.3 Soteriological flow: liberation by subtraction FACT:
Statement. FACT: Jaina liberation is primarily a matter of subtraction, not acquisition: the soul’s ananta-catuṣṭaya (infinite knowledge, infinite perception, infinite bliss, infinite power) is revealed when karmic obstruction is removed.
<pre>jīva (living conscious substance or soul) + ajīva (non-living reality) ▼ āsrava (influx of karmic matter) (influx of karma-pudgala) ▼ bandha (bondage) (adhesion through yoga + kaṣāya (passion binding karma)) +--> saṃvara (stoppage of karmic influx) (stops new influx) ▼ nirjarā (shedding of accumulated karma) (wears away accumulated karma (action and its morally consequential residue)) ▼ mokṣa (liberation) (all karma (action and its morally consequential residue) gone; ananta-catuṣṭaya (four infinite perfections of knowledge, perception, bliss and power) manifest)</pre>
Argument. FACT:
• FACT: The soul does not manufacture omniscience from nothing.
• FACT: It removes what obscures its intrinsic cognitive and blissful capacity.
• FACT: Kevala-jñāna is therefore revealed rather than produced.
• FACT: Mokṣa is the purified manifestation of what the jīva essentially is.

Presupposition. CAUTION: The self is intrinsically capable of perfection, but empirically veiled by beginningless karma.

Distinction. FACT: Jaina mokṣa is not acquisition of God's grace, not merger into Brahman, and not annihilation of self; it is release of an individual jīva from karmic matter.

Example. FACT: Cleaning a sooted lamp does not create light; it allows light to shine unobstructed.

Objection (Sāṃkhya/Vedānta objection). FACT: If the soul is intrinsically omniscient, why was it obscured at all?

Reply. FACT: The jīva-karma relation is **anādi** (beginningless) but not endless; like seed-and-tree or ore-and-gold analogies, there is no first temporal term, but purification can terminate the bondage.



3B. EIGHT KARMA-PRAKṚTIS (types or species of karma) AND THE MECHANICS OF BANDHA (bondage) FACT:



3B.1 Karma (action and its morally consequential residue) is material pudgala (matter capable of combination and disintegration) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jainism's philosophically distinctive thesis is that karma is literally material: **karma-pudgala** is subtle matter that flows into and adheres to the soul.

Argument. FACT:

- FACT: Empirical ignorance, delusion, embodied limitation, status, pleasure-pain, and lifespan require causal explanation.
- FACT: Jainism explains them through subtle material karmas rather than through an invisible moral potency alone.
- FACT: **Bhāva-karma** (the soul's psychical state) attracts **dravya-karma** (material karmic influx).
- FACT: Thus passions and activities have ontological consequences, not merely psychological consequences.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Moral causation is not merely legal or symbolic; it is a real interaction between a modified soul and subtle matter.

Distinction. FACT: This differs sharply from Nyāya **adrṣṭa**, Mīmāṃsā **apūrva**, Sāṃkhya **saṃskāra**, and Buddhist **vāsanā**, which are not material karmic particles.

Example. FACT: Anger makes the soul "sticky," as oil or wet clay gathers dust; the image expresses the causal role of kaṣāya.

Objection (Nyāya-Vedānta objection). FACT: How can material karma bind an immaterial conscious soul?

Reply. CAUTION: Jainism replies that the embodied jīva is not absolutely non-spatial: it has **pradeśas**, is co-extensive with the body, and is modified by bhāva-karma; karmic matter is attracted through passions. CAUTION: A residual difficulty remains because interaction between consciousness and matter still demands explanation.



3B.2 Eight basic karma-prakṛtis (types or species of karma) FACT:

Class	Karma-prakṛti (type or nature of karma)	What it obscures or determines	Philosophical significance
Ghātiyā (destructive karma obscuring essential capacities)	FACT: Jñānāvaraṇīya (knowledge-obscuring karma)	knowledge	FACT: Blocks the soul's intrinsic knowing
Ghātiyā (destructive karma obscuring essential capacities)	FACT: Darśanāvaraṇīya (perception-obscuring karma)	perception or apprehension	FACT: Blocks direct awareness
Ghātiyā (destructive karma obscuring essential capacities)	FACT: Mohanīya (deluding karma)	right vision and conduct	FACT: Most dangerous because delusion misorients the path
Ghātiyā (destructive karma obscuring essential capacities)	FACT: Antarāya (obstructive karma)	energy, power, capacity to act	FACT: Obstructs the soul's effective power
Aghātiyā (non-destructive karma shaping embodiment)	FACT: Vedanīya (feeling-producing karma)	pleasure and pain	FACT: Determines felt experience without destroying essence
Aghātiyā (non-destructive karma shaping embodiment)	FACT: Nāma (body-making karma)	body, form, embodiment	FACT: Determines the type of body and individuality of embodiment
Aghātiyā (non-destructive karma shaping embodiment)	FACT: Gotra (status-determining karma)	status or family-standing	FACT: Determines high or low status conditions
Aghātiyā (non-destructive karma shaping embodiment)	FACT: Āyus (lifespan-determining karma)	lifespan	FACT: Determines duration of embodied life

Statement. FACT: The eight karmas divide into **ghātiyā** karmas, which damage or obscure the soul's essential qualities, and **aghātiyā** karmas, which determine embodiment without directly destroying those qualities.

Argument. FACT:

- FACT: Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, mohanīya, and antarāya are ghātiyā because they obstruct knowledge, perception, right orientation, and power.

- FACT: Vedanīya, nāma, gotra, and āyus are aghātiyā because they structure embodied experience, body, status, and lifespan.

- FACT: **Mohaniya** is the most dangerous because delusion corrupts both right vision and right conduct.
 - FACT: Mohaniya is commonly divided into **darśana-mohaniya** and **cāritra-mohaniya**.
- Presupposition.** CAUTION: Liberation requires not only moral improvement but precise removal of the karmic veils that obstruct the soul’s essential nature.
- Distinction.** FACT: The arhat at the **sayoga-kevali** stage has destroyed ghātiyā karmas but still lives with remaining aghātiyā karmas until final release.
- Example.** FACT: A kevalin has omniscience because knowledge-obscuring karma is destroyed, but embodied life continues until lifespan-determining karma is exhausted.
- Objection (Buddhist objection).** FACT: The taxonomy seems metaphysically heavy compared with a mental-volitional account of karma.
- Reply.** CAUTION: Jainism accepts the heaviness because it wants a realist explanation of why cognition, embodiment, status, pleasure, and lifespan are all karmically structured.



3B.3 Four parameters of bandha (bondage) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Karmic bondage is analysed through four parameters: prakṛti (type or nature), sthiti (duration), anubhāga or rasa (intensity), and pradeśa (quantity of karmic matter).		
Bandha-parameter	Meaning	Main determinant
Prakṛti (type or nature of bondage)	FACT: type of karma (action and its morally consequential residue) bound	FACT: Yoga (activity of body, speech, and mind)
Sthiti (duration)	FACT: duration of bondage	FACT: Kaṣāya (passion binding karma) (passions)
Anubhāga (intensity) / rasa	FACT: intensity or fruition-strength	FACT: Kaṣāya (passion binding karma)
Pradeśa (quantity of karmic particles or spatial points)	FACT: quantity of karmic matter bound	FACT: Yoga
Argument. FACT:		
• FACT: Yoga brings karmic matter into relation with the soul and determines type and quantity.		
• FACT: Kaṣāya makes the bondage deep, long-lasting, and intense.		
• FACT: Activity without passion therefore has a radically different karmic effect from activity with passion.		
• FACT: This explains the contrast between īryāpathika bandha (momentary bondage from activity without passion) and sāmparāyika bandha (durable bondage from passion-coloured activity).		
Presupposition. CAUTION: The moral weight of an action depends not only on external movement but on passion, attachment, and delusion.		
Distinction. FACT: Jainism is not crude physicalism: material karma binds through psychical states; passion is doctrinally decisive.		
Example. FACT: A monk’s careful walking may involve bodily activity, but if free from passion it binds only momentarily; an angry act binds deeply because kaṣāya fixes the karma.		
Objection (Mīmāṃsā-Nyāya objection). FACT: This mechanism seems more elaborate than needed to explain moral consequence.		

Reply. CAUTION: Jainism replies that the elaboration is the point: it explains why intention, passion, duration, intensity, and embodiment are linked in a single karmic science.



3C. FOURTEEN GUṆASTHĀNAS (fourteen stages of spiritual development): STAGES OF SPIRITUAL DEVELOPMENT FACT:



3C.1 Ordered list FACT:

Statement. FACT: The **guṇasthānas** are fourteen ordered stages marking the soul’s gradual movement from delusion to omniscience and final liberation.

No.	Guṇasthāna (stage of spiritual development)	Brief gloss
1	FACT: Mithyā-dṛṣṭi (stage of false worldview)	false vision; complete wrong orientation
2	FACT: Sāsṡādana (stage retaining a taste of right vision) / sāsādana	falling condition with a lingering taste of right vision
3	FACT: Miśra (mixed worldview stage) / samyag-mithyā-dṛṣṭi	mixed right and wrong orientation
4	FACT: Avirata samyag-dṛṣṭi	right vision without full restraint
5	FACT: Deśavirata (partial self-restraint stage)	partial restraint, especially lay vows
6	FACT: Pramatta-saṡyata (self-restraint with carelessness)	full restraint with negligence
7	FACT: Apramatta-saṡyata (self-restraint without carelessness)	full restraint without negligence
8	FACT: Apūrva-karaṇa (unprecedented spiritual transformation) / nivṛtti-bādara	unprecedented purification; gross passions being transformed

No.	Guṇasthāna (stage of spiritual development)	Brief gloss
9	FACT: Anivṛtti-bādara (advanced stage with gross passions being transformed)	further advanced purification of gross passions
10	FACT: Sūkṡma-samparāya (stage of only subtle passion)	only subtle greed remains
11	FACT: Upaśānta-moha (stage of suppressed delusion)	delusion suppressed, not destroyed
12	FACT: Kṡiṇa-moha (stage of destroyed delusion)	delusion destroyed
13	FACT: Sayoga-kevali (omniscient being still engaged in activity)	omniscient embodied arhat with activity still present
14	FACT: Ayoga-kevali (omniscient being without bodily activity)	activity ceases; momentary final state before siddhatva

Argument. FACT:

- FACT: The first three stages describe wrong, falling, or mixed vision.
- FACT: Stage 4 is decisive because **samyag-darśana** first becomes stable enough to orient the path.
- FACT: Stages 5–7 discipline conduct through partial and full restraint.
- FACT: Stages 8–10 refine passions from gross to extremely subtle.

- FACT: Stages 11–12 mark the crucial difference between suppression and destruction of delusion.

- FACT: Stages 13–14 explain how omniscience and final disembodiment are related.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Liberation is gradual, psychologically exact, and karmically measurable.

Distinction. FACT: Stage 4 is a breakthrough in right vision; it is not yet complete ascetic conduct.

Example. FACT: A layperson with right vision and partial vows belongs doctrinally closer to stage 5 than to complete monastic purification.

Objection (Advaita-style objection). FACT: A fourteen-stage ladder may seem to turn liberation into a mechanical sequence rather than insight.

Reply. CAUTION: Jainism replies that insight, conduct, and karmic purification must be integrated; right vision without progressive destruction of karma is incomplete.



3C.2 Two ladders and jīvanmukti (liberation while embodied) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Jaina doctrine distinguishes **upaśama-śreṇi** (ladder of suppression) and **kṣapaka-śreṇi** (ladder of annihilation); only the annihilation ladder reaches irreversible destruction of delusion.

Argument. FACT:

- FACT: **Upaśama-śreṇi** suppresses delusion and can reach stage 11.

- FACT: Stage 11 necessarily falls back because suppressed moha is not destroyed.

- FACT: **Kṣapaka-śreṇi** destroys delusion and reaches stage 12 and beyond.

- FACT: At stage 13 the **sayoga-kevalī** has kevala-jñāna but still retains embodied activity because aghātiyā karmas remain.

- FACT: Stage 14, **ayoga-kevalī**, is the momentary cessation of activity immediately before **siddhatva**.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Suppression is spiritually unstable; destruction alone is final.

Distinction. FACT: The sayoga-kevalī is the Jaina answer to “is jīvanmukti possible?”: the embodied omniscient arhat is liberated-in-life in the Jaina sense, though final siddha-state follows only after remaining aghātiyā karmas are exhausted.

Example. FACT: A lamp with its obscuring cover removed shines fully even before the lamp is relocated; similarly the arhat is omniscient while embodied.

Objection (Rāmānuja-style objection). FACT: Omniscience while embodied may seem unintelligible if embodiment itself implies limitation.

Reply. CAUTION: Jainism distinguishes ghātiyā karmas, which obstruct essential knowledge, from aghātiyā karmas, which sustain embodiment without blocking omniscience.



3D. SALLEKHANĀ (ritual thinning of passions and body near unavoidable death) / SANTHĀRĀ (vow of disciplined fasting near unavoidable death): DEATH WITHOUT PASSION FACT:

Statement. FACT: **Sallekhanā** or **santhārā** is the voluntary, gradual, ritually regulated relinquishment of food and passions undertaken when death is unavoidable or bodily decline is incurable.

Argument. FACT:

- FACT: Bondage tracks **kaṣāya**: passion fixes karmic matter more deeply than bare activity.
- FACT: A death faced with equanimity minimizes new influx and prevents panic, attachment, and aversion from creating fresh bondage.
- FACT: The aim is not to end life as such but to end passion at the moment when life is already naturally or medically approaching its close.
- FACT: The practice must be free from desire for death, desire to continue living, attachment to friends, recollection of pleasures, and hope of reward.
- FACT: If such motives enter, the act becomes an **aticāra** (transgression) of the vow's proper discipline.

Presupposition. CAUTION: The karmic quality of dying depends on the inner state with which death is faced.

Distinction. FACT: Jainism distinguishes *sallekhanā* from **ātma-ghāta** (suicide): suicide is passion-driven, sudden, violent, often concealed, and motivated by despair or aversion; *sallekhanā* is passion-free, non-violent, gradual, supervised, and public.

Example. FACT: An elderly ascetic or lay practitioner facing irreversible decline may gradually reduce intake under religious supervision while cultivating forgiveness, detachment, and equanimity.

Objection (modern legal-ethical objection). QUESTION: Critics in India have disputed whether *sallekhanā* is protected religious practice or an impermissible form of self-destruction.

Reply. CAUTION: The Jaina reply is that legal and ethical evaluation must distinguish intention, procedure, publicity, non-violence, and the absence of death-desire; the controversy is a useful Paper II bridge to religion and morality, but specific case names, holdings, dates, and statutory details should not be asserted unless separately verified.



Exam route

2018, Q6(c), 15 marks: define bondage, distinguish bound and liberated souls, explain *bhāvabandha/dravyabandha*, and state the liberated condition.

2020, Q5(a), 10 marks and **2022, Q5(d), 10 marks:** focus on the bearing of material karma on liberation through *āsrava-bandha-saṃvara-nirjarā-mokṣa*.

2024, Q6(c), 15 marks: make the psychic/material distinction causal, not merely definitional, and add the four parameters of material bondage.

Use the three jewels and vows as mechanisms of *saṃvara* and *nirjarā*, not as an ornamental ethical list.



Rapid recall

- Karma is subtle material *pudgala*, not merely moral memory.
- Four *kaṣāyas*: anger, pride, deceit and greed.
- Seven *tattvas*; nine *padārthas* add merit and demerit.

- Eight karma-types divide into four destructive and four non-destructive classes.
- Four bandha parameters: type, duration, intensity and quantity.
- Liberation reveals intrinsic knowledge and bliss; individual *siddhas* do not merge.



Plain-language visual - what each rival attacks

BUDDHISM -> Why posit a permanent soul?
ADVAITA -> How can opposites be finally real?
NYAYA (school of logic and epistemology) -> How does soul expand with the body?
CARVAKA -> Where is evidence for karma (action and its morally consequential residue) and omniscience?
JAINA REPLY -> each criticism absolutises one dimension

In simple words: rival schools attack different joints of the Jaina system. A good answer must name the target accurately before giving the Jaina reply.

Rival	Main pressure point
Buddhism	Permanence amid change
Advaita	Real plurality and opposed predicates
Nyāya (school of logic and epistemology)	Soul-body extension and material karma (action and its morally consequential residue)
Cārvāka (Indian materialist and perception-centred school)	Unverifiable soul, karma (action and its morally consequential residue) and omniscience

Memory line: state the critic's criterion first; then show what the Jaina distinction saves and what burden remains.



4. INTER-THINKER / INTER-SCHOOL DEBATES CAUTION:

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) mediates between Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), Buddhist flux and Advaita (non-dualism) by defending a many-sided reality of enduring substances that genuinely undergo changing modes.



4.1 Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation) vs Buddhism on reality

Axis	Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation)	Buddhism
Self	Many enduring jīvas (plural form: living conscious substance or soul)	Anātman (no permanent self) / no enduring self-substance
Reality	Substance with permanence-in-change	Strong tendency to momentariness in many schools
Logic of judgement	Conditional many-sided predication	Often sharper critiques of substantial identity

Axis	Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation)	Buddhism
Karma (action and its morally consequential residue)	Material karmic accretion	Moral-causal continuity without material karmic particles
Liberation	Distinct soul freed from karma (action and its morally consequential residue)	Nirvāṇa (cessation of craving and conditioned suffering) without eternal self



4.2 Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation) vs Advaita Vedānta (Upaniṣad-based end-of-the-Veda tradition)

Axis	Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation)	Advaita
Ultimate reality	Pluralistic	Non-dual Brahman
World	Real	Empirically real, ultimately dependent / mithyā
Souls	Many real jivas (plural form: living conscious substance or soul)	Ultimately one ātman (enduring self or soul)/Brahman
Ignorance/bondage	Karmic material obscuration	Avidyā (ignorance) / adhyāsa (superimposition)
Liberation	Distinct siddhas (plural form: liberated perfected soul)	Realization of non-duality



4.3 Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation) vs Cārvāka (Indian materialist and perception-centred school)

Axis	Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation)	Cārvāka (Indian materialist and perception-centred school)
Ontology	Pluralist realism with soul and karma (action and its morally consequential residue)	Materialist minimalism
Karma (action and its morally consequential residue)	Material and real	Rejected
Liberation	Central	Denied or emptied
Logic	Conditional predication	Suspicion of inference and testimony
Ethics	Austerity and ahiṃsā (non-violence)	This-worldly pleasure and prudence



5. NAMED CRITICISMS AND JAINA REPLIES FACT:

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The charge that anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) is self-refuting fails if its own claim is understood as standpoint-qualified rather than as an unqualified absolute denial of absolutes.



5.1 Śaṃkara's critique of anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Śaṃkara, in the <i>Brahmasūtra-bhāṣya</i> , criticizes Jaina anekāntavāda by arguing that contradictory attributes cannot belong to the same thing in the same way.
Argument of the critic. FACT:
• FACT: If the same object is said to be both existent and non-existent, determinate knowledge is threatened.
• FACT: If everything is “somehow yes and somehow no,” practical action loses clear guidance.
• FACT: If anekāntavāda asserts itself absolutely, it contradicts itself.
• FACT: If it asserts itself only conditionally, it seems to lose universal force.
Presupposition. CAUTION: A viable metaphysics must preserve non-contradiction and assertoric clarity.
Jaina reply. FACT:
• FACT: Opposed predicates are indexed to distinct standpoints: dravya (substance), kṣetra (place), kāla (time), and bhāva (mode).
• FACT: There is no contradiction unless affirmation and negation are made in the same respect, place, time, and mode.
• FACT: Syādvāda is itself asserted syāt ; this reflexive qualification is a virtue because the doctrine obeys its own rule.
• CAUTION: A residual objection remains: if syādvāda is always qualified, critics may say it loses final assertoric force.



5.2 Rāmānuja's critique: opposed real attributes FACT:
Statement. FACT: Rāmānuja presses the charge that a real substance with really opposed attributes is unintelligible.
Argument of the critic. FACT:
• FACT: A thing cannot be genuinely both F and not-F in the same meaningful sense.
• FACT: If the attributes are real and opposed, the substance becomes incoherent.
• FACT: If they are not real, Jaina realism weakens.
Presupposition. CAUTION: Real predication must avoid contradiction at the level of the object, not merely at the level of language.
Jaina reply. FACT: The Jaina answer again uses standpoint-indexing: the same dravya persists while paryāyas arise and cease, so the opposition is between aspects, not within one unqualified predication.
Assessment. CAUTION: The reply works best if one accepts the dravya-paryāya distinction; it is less persuasive to schools that reject such aspect-realism.



5.3 Dharmakīrti / Buddhist critique of permanent-yet-changing soul FACT:

Statement. FACT: A Buddhist critique associated with Dharmakīrti's causal-efficacy style of argument challenges the Jaina soul as permanent yet changing.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

- FACT: If the soul expands and contracts with the body, it undergoes real change.
- FACT: What undergoes real change cannot be absolutely permanent.
- FACT: A permanent entity that changes faces the **arthakriyā** (causal efficacy) dilemma: if it acts, it changes; if it does not change, it cannot act.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Causal efficacy and permanence are difficult to combine in one substance.

Jaina reply. FACT: Jainism replies through **utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya**: origination, cessation, and permanence are simultaneously real features of every sat; the substance is permanent qua dravya and changing qua paryāya.

Assessment. CAUTION: The Buddhist objection remains strong if one denies the real distinction between substance and modes.



5.4 Nyāya (school of logic and epistemology) critique of the soul's expansion and material karma (action and its morally consequential residue) FACT:

Statement. FACT: Nyāya criticizes the Jaina view that the soul is co-extensive with the body and expands or contracts like a lamp filling a room.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

- FACT: An eternal self should not literally expand and contract.
- FACT: If the self has parts or pradeśas, its eternity seems threatened.
- FACT: Material karma is less parsimonious than an unseen moral potency such as adṛṣṭa.

Presupposition. CAUTION: A permanent self should be partless or at least not spatially variable.

Jaina reply. FACT: Jainism invokes **pradeśas** and the lamp simile: consciousness can pervade the body without being identical with gross matter, and karmic pudgala explains concrete embodiment better than a merely invisible potency.

Assessment. CAUTION: The reply is internally coherent within Jaina pluralism, but the interaction of conscious pradeśa-bearing jīva and matter remains a debated point.



5.5 Sāṃkhya (dualistic enumeration school)/Vedānta (Upaniṣad-based end-of-the-Veda tradition) critique of intrinsic omniscience and beginningless bondage FACT:

Statement. FACT: Sāṃkhya and Vedānta-style objections ask why karmic matter obscures an intrinsically omniscient soul and what began the obscuration.

Argument of the critic. FACT:

- FACT: If the soul is intrinsically pure and omniscient, obscuration appears accidental and inexplicable.

- **FACT:** If karma began at some time, a first cause of bondage is required.

- **FACT:** If karma never began, liberation may seem impossible.

Presupposition. CAUTION: A theory of bondage must explain both its origin and its removal.

Jaina reply. **FACT:** The jīva-karma relation is **anādi** (beginningless) but not endless; like seed-and-tree or ore-and-gold analogies, there is no first temporal term, but disciplined saṃvara and nirjarā can terminate the relation.

Assessment. CAUTION: The reply blocks a first-cause demand but leaves a metaphysical puzzle about why beginningless bondage is possible for an intrinsically perfect soul.



5.6 Cārvāka (Indian materialist and perception-centred school) / empiricist critique of omniscience and liberation **FACT:**

Statement. **FACT:** A Cārvāka or modern empiricist objection rejects invisible souls, karmic particles, omniscience, and siddha-śīlā as unverifiable.

Argument of the critic. **FACT:** Ordinary perception does not disclose karmic matter, disembodied siddhas, or omniscient cognition.

Presupposition. CAUTION: Only publicly verifiable empirical entities should be admitted.

Jaina reply. CAUTION: Jainism combines testimony, inference, moral phenomenology, and the internal logic of purification to defend these doctrines, but it cannot satisfy a strict materialist who admits only gross perception.

Assessment. CAUTION: Use this objection only as an external critique; do not let it replace the named classical objections above.



Exam route

Use a four-column dialectic: **critic** -> **exact objection** -> **Jaina distinction/reply** -> **residual problem**.

For "critically discuss", exposition must come before criticism. For comparison, select named axes rather than writing two isolated summaries. The **2025 pluralism and realism** PYQ is the best place to integrate Buddhist, Advaita, Nyāya and Cārvāka pressure.



Rapid recall

- Criticism is strongest when its criterion is named.

- Indexed opposites answer contradiction better than the slogan "all views are true".

- Permanent substance explains continuity but increases ontological commitment.

- Material karma integrates ethics and embodiment but creates an interaction problem.

- Omniscience blocks total relativism but needs independent support.



Plain-language visual - the complete answer spine

DEFINE THE AXIS
 |
 RECONSTRUCT JAINA DOCTRINE
 |
 SHOW THE INTERNAL LINK
 reality -> judgement -> conduct -> liberation
 |
 ADD NAMED OBJECTION + BEST REPLY
 |
 GIVE A QUALIFIED VERDICT

In simple words: a Jaina answer scores when it shows relationships. Do not merely list six substances, seven predicates or five stages; explain why each structure follows from the larger system.

Marks	Minimum architecture
10	Definition -> core mechanism -> distinction -> verdict
15	Doctrine -> structure/example -> criticism/reply -> assessment
20	Full derivation -> comparison -> dialectic -> criterion-based conclusion

Memory line: many-sided reality requires qualified judgement; purified judgement and conduct remove bondage.



6. COMMON UPSC TRAPS FACT:

- **Anekāntavāda ≠ syādvāda ≠ saptabhaṅgī.** FACT: Metaphysics / epistemic-logical method / formal sevenfold predication.
- **Karma in Jainism is material (pudgala).** FACT: Do not reduce it to generic moral force or adrṣṭa.
- **Six dravyas, but only five astikāyas.** FACT: Kāla is a dravya but not an astikāya; the pañcāstikāya list has five members while the dravya list has six.
- **Jainism rejects God as creator but not spiritual excellence.** FACT: Liberated souls and Tirthaṅkaras are worthy of reverence, but there is no creator-God.
- **Bhāvabandha ≠ dravyabandha.** FACT: Psychic bondage is not identical with material karmic bondage, though they are linked.
- **Dharma / adharma in ontology do not mean moral merit / sin.** FACT: They are media of motion and rest.
- **Seven nayas are not the same as seven bhāṅgas.** FACT: One is standpoint taxonomy; the other is predicational schema.
- **Jainism is realist despite epistemic relativity.** CAUTION: Partial knowledge does not imply unreal objects.
- **Jaina pratyakṣa is inverted.** FACT: Strict pratyakṣa is soul-direct knowledge; ordinary sense-perception is only sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa.
- **Puṇya is not mokṣa.** FACT: Merit may improve saṃsāric condition but still belongs to karmic involvement.

- **Ghātiyā ≠ aghātiyā karma.** FACT: Ghātiyā karmas obstruct essential qualities; aghātiyā karmas determine embodiment.
- **Sayoga-kevalī = Jaina jīvanmukta.** FACT: Omniscience can occur while embodied because aghātiyā karmas remain until final siddhatva.



7. KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK FACT:

- **Anekāntavāda** — doctrine of many-sided reality. FACT:
- **Sat = utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya** — reality involves origination, decay, and permanence. FACT:
- **Dravya-guṇa-paryāya** — substance, qualities, modes. FACT:
- **Jīva / ajīva** — conscious and non-conscious reals. FACT:
- **Syādvāda** — conditional predication. FACT:
- **Saptabhaṅgī** — sevenfold judgement-schema. FACT:
- **Bhāvabandha / dravyabandha** — psychic and material bondage. FACT:
- **Ratnatraya** — right faith, right knowledge, right conduct. FACT:
- **Kevala-jñāna** — omniscience of the purified soul. FACT:
- **Siddha-śīlā** — topmost locus of liberated souls. FACT:
- **Exam sentence:** “Jaina realism is qualified not because reality is doubtful, but because finite judgement reaches the real only under conditioned standpoints.” CAUTION:
- **Exam sentence:** “The originality of Jaina soteriology lies in treating karma not merely as moral record but as subtle material bondage requiring both stoppage and shedding.” CAUTION:

<!-- restored-2018-2020-doctrine:start -->



RESTORED 2018/2020 DOCTRINE DOSSIER



Bound and liberated soul

- FACT: **Bondage:** karmic matter flows toward the jīva through activity and passions, becomes bound to it, obscures its infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss, and determines embodiment.
- FACT: **Liberation sequence:** saṃvara stops new influx; nirjarā sheds accumulated karma; the purified jīva rises to the siddha-śīlā and remains an individual perfected soul.
- CAUTION: **Distinction:** the liberated soul is not merged into a universal consciousness; numerical individuality survives without karmic limitation.

- QUESTION: **Objection** -> **reply**: material karma interacting with an immaterial conscious jīva appears category-confused. Jainism treats karmic matter as subtle and invokes the jīva's embodied expansion/contraction, though the mechanism remains contestable.

<!-- restored-2018-2020-doctrine:end -->

<!-- expanded-pyq-depth:start -->



CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (complete 2018–2025 audit)

- CAUTION: **Priority**: Primary ownership rises to 9 of 112 parts and occurs in every year.
- FACT: **Required doctrinal depth**: The restored papers require the mechanics of bondage, bound versus liberated soul, the condition of the siddha, and karma’s direct bearing on liberation.
- **Trap / answer consequence**: Do not reduce liberation to moral improvement alone: map influx, bondage, stoppage, shedding and the persistence of perfected individual jīva.

<!-- expanded-pyq-depth:end -->



7A. PRESUPPOSITION LEDGER CAUTION:		
Doctrine	Presupposition	What collapses if denied
Anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality)	CAUTION: Reality has many real aspects, not merely many subjective descriptions	CAUTION: Jaina non-absolutism becomes either skepticism or loose tolerance
Nayavāda (theory of partial standpoints)	CAUTION: Finite cognition grasps objects through partial standpoints	CAUTION: Partial truths become either falsehoods or dogmatic absolutes
Syādvāda (doctrine of qualified or conditional assertion) / saptabhaṅgī (sevenfold predication)	CAUTION: Language must register standpoint, time, place, substance, and mode	CAUTION: Conditional predication looks like contradiction or indecision
Dravya (substance) as utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya (origination, decay and persistence)	CAUTION: Permanence and change are both objectively real in different respects	CAUTION: Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation) collapses either into Buddhist flux or static monism
Five/six substances and astikāya (extended substance occupying spatial points)	CAUTION: Substance and spatial extension must be distinguished	CAUTION: Kāla (time) is confused with the five astikāyas (extended substances occupying spatial points), and pluralist cosmology loses precision
Material karma (action and its morally consequential residue)	CAUTION: Moral-psychical states can attract subtle matter	CAUTION: Bondage becomes metaphorical and Jaina soteriology loses its distinctive mechanism
Guṇasthāna (stage of spiritual development) progression	CAUTION: Spiritual development is gradual and karmically measurable	CAUTION: Liberation becomes abrupt insight without Jaina moral psychology
Kevala-jñāna (perfect omniscience)	CAUTION: The soul’s infinite knowledge is intrinsic but obscured	CAUTION: Mokṣa (liberation) becomes acquisition rather than revelation through removal

Doctrine	Presupposition	What collapses if denied
Ahiṃsā (non-violence)	CAUTION: All living jīvas (plural form: living conscious substance or soul) are morally significant and injury binds karma (action and its morally consequential residue)	CAUTION: Jaina ethics loses its metaphysical foundation



7B. PŪRVAPAKṢA (opponent's prima-facie position)–SIDDHĀNTA (established conclusion) LEDGER FACT:

Objector (named)	Objection	Jaina reply	Residual force CAUTION:
Śaṃkara	FACT: Anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) allows contradiction and cannot assert itself consistently	FACT: Predicates are indexed to dravya (substance), kṣetra (field, body or domain), kāla (time), and bhāva (psychic state or mode); syādvāda (doctrine of qualified or conditional assertion) is itself asserted syāt (in a certain respect or conditionally)	CAUTION: Reflexively qualified doctrine may seem to lose assertoric force
Rāmānuja	FACT: A real substance with opposed real attributes is unintelligible	FACT: Opposed predicates belong to different aspects of dravya (substance) and paryāya (changing mode)	CAUTION: Reply depends on accepting aspect-realism
Dharmakīrti / Buddhist	FACT: Permanent yet changing soul fails the arthakriyā (causal efficacy) test	FACT: Utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya (origination, decay and persistence): permanence as dravya (substance), change as paryāya (changing mode)	CAUTION: Strong if substance-mode distinction is denied
Nyāya (school of logic and epistemology)	FACT: Soul's expansion/contraction and material karma (action and its morally consequential residue) are unparsimonious	FACT: Jīva (living conscious substance or soul) has pradeśas (plural form: quantity of karmic particles or spatial points) and pervades the body like a lamp; karma-pudgala explains embodiment	CAUTION: Consciousness-matter interaction remains difficult
Sāṃkhya (dualistic enumeration school)/Vedānta (Upaniṣad-based end-of-the-Veda tradition)	FACT: Intrinsic omniscience plus beginningless obscuration seems puzzling	FACT: Jīva-karma (relation between the soul and karmic matter) relation is anādi (beginningless) but terminable through saṃvara (stoppage of karmic influx) and nirjarā (shedding of accumulated karma)	CAUTION: No first-origin explanation is offered
Cārvāka (Indian materialist and perception-centred school) / empiricist	FACT: Soul, karma-pudgala, omniscience, and siddha-śilā (realm of liberated souls) are not perceptually verified	CAUTION: Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation) uses inference, testimony, and systematic soteriology	CAUTION: Unpersuasive to strict perception-only materialism



7C. INTER-SCHOOL POSITIONING FACT:

School	Pramāṇas (plural form: means of valid knowledge) admitted	Self	Permanence vs change	Universals	Causation	Creator God	Liberation
Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation)	FACT: Pratyakṣa (perception) and parokṣa (indirect or mediated knowledge); developed accounts include anumāna (inference), śabda (verbal testimony), smṛti (memory), pratyabhijñā, tarka (hypothetical or reductio reasoning)	FACT: Many permanent jīvas (plural form: living conscious substance or soul)	FACT: Dravya (substance) permanent, paryāya (changing mode) changing	CAUTION: Real features grasped under standpoints	FACT: Sadasatkāryavāda (doctrine that the effect is both existent and non-existent in qualified respects) : effect exists in one respect in the cause because dravya (substance) persists, and does not exist in another because paryāya (changing mode) is new	FACT: Aniśvaravāda (denial of a creator God) : no creator; Tirthaṅkaras (plural form: liberated ford-maker and teacher) are liberated teachers	FACT: Individual siddha (liberated perfected soul) freed from all karma (action and its morally consequential residue)
Buddhism	CAUTION: Usually perception and inference in classical epistemology	FACT: No permanent ātman (enduring self or soul)	FACT: Momentariness in many schools	CAUTION: Often nominal or conceptual	CAUTION: Dependent origination, no permanent substrate	FACT: No creator God	FACT: Nirvāṇa (cessation of craving and conditioned suffering) without eternal soul-substance
Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika (combined realist traditions of logic and categories)	FACT: Perception, inference, comparison, testimony	FACT: Many eternal selves	FACT: Substances endure; qualities change	FACT: Universals real	FACT: Asatkāryavāda (doctrine that the effect is newly produced); effect newly produced	FACT: Theistic in later Nyāya (school of logic and epistemology)	FACT: Self freed from suffering, not Jaina omniscient bliss
Sāṃkhya-Yoga (paired traditions of dualist enumeration and disciplined practice)	FACT: Perception, inference, reliable testimony	FACT: Many puruṣas (plural form: person or conscious principle)	FACT: Puruṣa (person or conscious principle) changeless; prakṛti (type or nature of bondage) evolves	CAUTION: Not central like Nyāya (school of logic and epistemology) universals	FACT: Satkāryavāda (doctrine that the effect pre-exists in its cause); effect pre-exists in cause	FACT: Classical Sāṃkhya (dualistic enumeration school) non-theistic; Yoga admits Īśvara (Lord or creator God) specially	FACT: Kaivalya of puruṣa (person or conscious principle) from prakṛti (type or nature of bondage)
Mīmāṃsā (Vedic exegesis school)	FACT: Multiple pramāṇas (plural form: means of valid knowledge) including śabda (verbal testimony); exact list varies by sub-school	FACT: Enduring self	FACT: World and Veda treated as real	FACT: Realist tendencies	CAUTION: Apūrva (unseen ritual potency) links ritual action and result	FACT: No creator required for Vedic authority	CAUTION: Often cessation of pain / ritual-moral fulfilment depending on account

School	Pramāṇas (plural form: means of valid knowledge) admitted	Self	Permanence vs change	Universals	Causation	Creator God	Liberation
Advaita	FACT: Six pramāṇas (plural form: means of valid knowledge) in standard Advaita pedagogy	FACT: Ultimately one ātman-Brahman (identity of self and ultimate reality)	FACT: Brahman changeless; world mithyā	CAUTION: Ultimately sublated in non-duality	CAUTION: Vivarta-style appearance rather than real transformation	CAUTION: Īśvara (Lord or creator God) is empirical-soteriological, not ultimate second reality	FACT: Realization of non-duality
Cārvāka (Indian materialist and perception-centred school)	FACT: Perception primarily	FACT: Body-based consciousness	FACT: Material change only	QUESTION: Universals not central as real entities	CAUTION: Material causal regularity	FACT: Rejects creator God	FACT: Rejects mokṣa (liberation) or reduces goal to this-worldly life

Focused Jainism vs Buddhism. FACT: Both are śramaṇa traditions, both challenge Vedic ritual supremacy, and both reject a creator God. FACT: Jainism, however, affirms many permanent jīvas and permanent-cum-changing substances, whereas Buddhism rejects substance-self. FACT: Jaina ahiṃsā is far more radical because even minute living beings are jīvas. FACT: Jaina karma is material karma-pudgala, while Buddhist karma is primarily volitional or mental-causal continuity. CAUTION: Thus the two are close historically but sharply opposed metaphysically.



7D. CONTROLLED WESTERN COMPARISON CAUTION:

Western comparison	Point of contact	Disanalogy
Anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) and Nietzschean perspectivism	CAUTION: Both deny a simple “view from nowhere” for ordinary knowers	FACT: Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation) is realist: aspects are in the object; perspectivism is often read anti-realist
Syādvāda (doctrine of qualified or conditional assertion) and many-valued / paraconsistent logic	CAUTION: Seven bhaṅgas (seven predicative modes) resemble non-classical evaluation	FACT: Syāt (in a certain respect or conditionally) is a standpoint-operator, not a third truth-value; avaktavya (inexpressible under a simultaneous unqualified formulation) is inexpressibility in one unqualified utterance, not a truth-value gap
Anekānta (many-sidedness) and Hegelian dialectic	CAUTION: Both allow opposites within the real	FACT: Hegelian opposites are sublated into higher synthesis; Jaina aspects coexist without sublation
Ahiṃsā (non-violence) and Schweitzer’s reverence for life	CAUTION: Both widen moral concern toward life	FACT: Jaina ahiṃsā (non-violence) is grounded in jīva (living conscious substance or soul), karma (action and its morally consequential residue), and liberation, not only ethical reverence
Jaina souls and Leibnizian monads	CAUTION: Both are plural centres carrying their own history	FACT: Jaina souls interact with karmic matter and vary in spatial extension; monads do not interact materially in the same way
Material karma (action and its morally consequential residue) and mechanistic psychology	CAUTION: Both seek causal explanation for conduct and character	FACT: Jaina karma (action and its morally consequential residue) is subtle moral matter tied to liberation, not value-neutral brain mechanism

Rubric. CAUTION: Western parallels are illustrative only, never a substitute for the Jaina argument; use at most one or two lines after the Jaina case is complete.

**7E. DIRECTIVE DECODER CAUTION:**

Directive	What the examiner is testing	Structural move for a Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation) answer	Closing verdict
Discuss	FACT: Breadth plus coherence	Define doctrine -> explain mechanics -> add one debate	CAUTION: "Thus Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation) offers a coherent pluralist realism, though its metaphysical costs remain."
Examine	FACT: Doctrinal accuracy	Break into components: dravya (substance), naya (partial standpoint), syāt (in a certain respect or conditionally), karma (action and its morally consequential residue), mokṣa (liberation)	CAUTION: "The doctrine is intelligible when its presuppositions are made explicit."
Critically examine	FACT: Doctrine plus objections	Present Śaṃkara/Nyāya (school of logic and epistemology)/Buddhist objections and Jaina replies	CAUTION: "The reply is strong internally but not neutral across all schools."
Analyse	FACT: Internal logic	Show cause-effect links: metaphysics -> epistemology -> language -> liberation	CAUTION: "Its strength lies in systematic interconnection."
Evaluate	FACT: Balanced judgement	State strengths, weaknesses, and residual contestation	CAUTION: "Persuasive as qualified realism; vulnerable on material karma (action and its morally consequential residue) and omniscience."
Compare	FACT: Inter-school positioning	Use axes: self, causation, pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge), karma (action and its morally consequential residue), mokṣa (liberation)	CAUTION: "The comparison shows Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation) as a middle path between flux and static permanence."
Distinguish	FACT: Conceptual precision	Use tables: anekānta (many-sidedness)/syādvāda (doctrine of qualified or conditional assertion)/saptabhaṅgī (sevenfold predication); bhāva (psychic state or mode)/dravya (substance) bandha (bondage)	CAUTION: "The distinction prevents common UPSC conflation."
Elucidate	FACT: Clear explanation with examples	Define -> give example -> link to soteriology	CAUTION: "The example reveals the doctrinal logic, not merely illustration."

Directive	What the examiner is testing	Structural move for a Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation) answer	Closing verdict
Comment	FACT: Short evaluative insight	State thesis and one philosophical implication	CAUTION: "The comment should be pointed, not a full survey."
Bring out	FACT: Hidden relation	Show how reality is reflected in judgement or karma (action and its morally consequential residue) in liberation	CAUTION: "The relation is constitutive, not accidental."
Do you agree?	FACT: Reasoned stance	Agree partly -> give doctrine -> objections -> qualified verdict	CAUTION: "Agree within Jaina presuppositions; qualify from rival standpoints."

**7F. GRADED VERDICT ON JAINISM (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation) CAUTION:**

Strong FACT:

- FACT: Jainism gives one of the clearest Indian accounts of how permanence and change can both be real.
- FACT: Anekāntavāda, nayavāda, and syādvāda form a disciplined sequence from ontology to epistemology to language.
- FACT: Its material karma doctrine makes ethics causally serious and connects metaphysics with ascetic practice.
- FACT: Its ahimsā follows directly from plural jīvas and karmic bondage, not from sentiment alone.

Weak CAUTION:

- CAUTION: Material karma binding a conscious soul remains difficult for non-Jaina metaphysics.
- CAUTION: Omniscience and higher direct knowledges are hard to verify externally.
- CAUTION: The system can seem over-taxonomic in karma-types, guṇasthānas, and nayas.
- CAUTION: Reflexively qualified syādvāda may appear to weaken its own universal claim.

Genuinely contested QUESTION:

- QUESTION: Sectarian nuances about kāla's substantial independence differ in presentation.
- QUESTION: Modern legal-ethical evaluation of sallekhanā requires case-specific verification before citing details.
- QUESTION: Historical dating of several Jaina thinkers should not be asserted unless separately verified.

Ready verdicts. CAUTION:

- **10 marks:** Jainism is a pluralistic realism that avoids both pure permanence and pure flux by making every real a unity of dravya and paryāya.
- **15 marks:** Its genius lies in connecting many-sided reality with conditional judgement, but its material karma and omniscience doctrines remain philosophically contestable.
- **20 marks:** Jainism is best evaluated as a rigorous qualified realism: internally systematic, ethically powerful, and logically subtle, though vulnerable to external critiques of contradiction, soul-matter interaction, and unverifiable higher knowledge.

**8. PYQ ROUTING (2018–2025)**

CAUTION: Corpus signal: 9 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper I corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2018	Q6(c)	15 marks	How do the Jaina philosophers explain 'bondage'? What, according to them, is the distinction between 'liberated soul' and 'bound soul'? What do the Jainas think about the condition of the 'liberated soul'? Discuss.
2019	Q6(a)	20 marks	How is reality defined by the Jainas? How is this theory of reality reflected in their view on judgements? Discuss.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2020	Q5(a)	10 marks	Examine the concept of Karma (action and its morally consequential residue) according to Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation). How does it bear upon their conception of Liberation?
2021	Q7(c)	15 marks	Explain the Jaina view of seven-fold (sapta-bhaṅgī (sevenfold predication)) 'Naya (partial standpoint)'.
2022	Q5(d)	10 marks	How does Jaina view of Karma (action and its morally consequential residue) bear upon their soteriology? Critically discuss.
2022	Q6(b)	15 marks	'The doctrine of Relativism of Jain Philosophy cannot be logically sustained without postulating 'Absolutism'.' Critically examine this view and give reasons in the favour of your answer.
2023	Q5(a)	10 marks	"All human knowledge is empirical and therefore relative." Critically examine Jaina theory of sevenfold judgement (saptabhaṅgīnaya (sevenfold standpoint-based judgement)) in the light of above statement.
2024	Q6(c)	15 marks	What is the distinction between Bhāvabandha (psychic or intentional bondage) and Dravyabandha (material karmic bondage), according to the Jainas? Discuss.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2025	Q7(c)	15 marks	Is Jaina philosophy pluralistic and realistic? Critically discuss.

See the Indian Philosophy PYQ Bank, 2018–2025.



9. ANSWER ARCHITECTURE (10 / 15 / 20 marks) CAUTION:

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Final verdict: Jaina philosophy combines metaphysical pluralism, perspectival logic and ethical self-purification, but its coherence depends on showing that conditional predication preserves truth without collapsing into contradiction or relativism.



9.1 10-mark answer

Define the key term precisely: anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality), syādvāda (doctrine of qualified or conditional assertion), karma (action and its morally consequential residue), or bhāvabandha (psychic or intentional bondage).
 Give the doctrinal core in 3–4 compact points.
 Add one distinction that prevents confusion (e.g., anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) vs syādvāda (doctrine of qualified or conditional assertion)).
 Close with one evaluative line or exam-relevant implication.



9.2 15-mark answer

Frame the issue: Jainism (Jina-centred path of non-violence, many-sided reality and liberation) balances realism with non-absolutism.
 Body A: explain the doctrine requested (reality / sevenfold judgement / bondage).
 Body B: add structure—tables, ordered seven predicates, or bondage sequence.
 Body C: include one criticism and one reply.
 Conclude with a clear philosophical verdict, not mere summary.



9.3 20-mark answer

Open by linking metaphysics and judgement: many-sided reality requires qualified predication.
 Section 1: define reality via dravya (substance), guṇa (quality), paryāya (changing mode), utpāda-vyaya-dhrauṇya (origination, decay and persistence).
 Section 2: show reflection in nayavāda (theory of partial standpoints), syādvāda (doctrine of qualified or conditional assertion), saptaṅgaṇī (sevenfold predication).
 Section 3: if asked, connect to soul, karma (action and its morally consequential residue), and liberation.
 Section 4: critically assess pluralism, realism, and self-refutation objections.
 End with a balanced conclusion: realism without dogmatism.

**10. LINK-OUTS**

- Carvaka.md
- Buddhism.md
- Vedanta.md
- Pramāṇa across schools
- Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique
- Indian Philosophy PYQ bank, 2018–2025

**SOURCES**

- *Tattvārthasūtra* / *Tattvārthādhigama-sūtra* (named without invented sūtra numbers).
- Chatterjee & Datta, *An Introduction to Indian Philosophy*.
- C.D. Sharma, *A Critical Survey of Indian Philosophy*.
- S. Radhakrishnan, *Indian Philosophy*, Vol. I.

**Exam route**

The complete 2018-2025 route contains **nine verified topic-owned questions**. Match each question to its centre of gravity:

- Reality and judgement: 2019.
- Karma and liberation: 2020 and 2022.
- Sevenfold judgement: 2021 and 2023.

- Absolutism objection: 2022.
 - Bound/liberated soul and bondage: 2018 and 2024.
 - Pluralism and realism: 2025.
- Use the answer architectures and directive decoder in the retained source material below. The full model solutions, MCQs and original practice follow immediately after the layered teaching.



Rapid recall - final master matrix

Prompt	Recall spine
Reality	<i>utpāda (origination) + vyaya (cessation or decay) + dhrauvya (persistence)</i>
Ontology	<i>six dravyas (plural form: substance); five astikāyas (extended substances occupying spatial points) plus time</i>
Logic	<i>anekānta (many-sidedness) -> naya (partial standpoint) -> syāt (in a certain respect or conditionally) -> seven bhaṅgas (seven predicative modes)</i>
Bondage	<i>passion -> bhāvabandha (psychic or intentional bondage) -> dravyabandha (material karmic bondage)</i>
Release	<i>āsrava (influx of karmic matter) -> bandha (bondage) -> saṃvara (stoppage of karmic influx) -> nirjarā (shedding of accumulated karma) -> mokṣa (liberation)</i>
Path	<i>right vision + right knowledge + right conduct</i>
Verdict	<i>pluralistic realism with qualified predication</i>

Complete the integrated and remedial MCQs in the practice section before using the final consolidated register notes.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH — NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER



Layer-placement note

All Layer 3 material from the legacy complete session is retained here after practice. It should refine a core answer, not displace the printed syllabus.



Advanced synthesis

The cross-sectarian standing of the *Tattvārthasūtra* supplies a common doctrinal grammar without erasing Śvetāmbara-Digambara differences. This matters methodologically: cite the text as a shared systematic anchor, but do not infer complete uniformity of canon or practice. Tirthaṅkaras are perfected teachers rather than creators, so Jaina religious authority remains compatible with an uncreated cosmos.

The deeper philosophical architecture is reciprocal. Metaphysical many-sidedness explains epistemic partiality; epistemic discipline supports ethical non-violence in thought; ethical purification removes the karmic obstruction that prevents complete knowledge. Treating these as unrelated chapters misses the system's unity.



Advanced objections, replies and comparisons

Contradiction objection: how can permanence and change belong to one real? The Jaina reply indexes them to different ontological dimensions: permanence belongs to substance, while origination and decay belong to modes. This anticipates the broader strategy of standpoint qualification.

Buddhist challenge: an enduring substrate may appear unnecessary if causal continuity explains identity. Jainism replies that change is intelligible as the change *of* something and that a real bearer better explains responsibility and liberation.

Advaita challenge: plurality may be only empirical appearance. Jainism treats difference, matter and individual souls as ultimately real; liberation does not dissolve numerical individuality.

Nyāya challenge: *dharma-dravya* and *adharma-dravya* look unparsimonious. The Jaina defence treats them as enabling media, not forces or moral properties. The hardest remaining burden is the interaction of conscious *jīva* with material *pudgala*.



Advanced evaluation

The Jaina inversion of ordinary terminology is a frequent source of error: strict *pratyakṣa* is independent of senses and mind, whereas ordinary sensory cognition is conventionally direct but philosophically mediated. This scheme supports non-absolutism because finite embodied knowledge is partial, not because objects are unreal.

The strongest external difficulty concerns higher cognition and omniscience. These states organise the system's account of complete truth, but they are difficult to verify from an ordinary standpoint. A second difficulty is circularity: complete knowledge validates the many-sided system, while the system explains why complete knowledge exists. The Jaina reply appeals to graded removal of obscuring karma, but the evidential burden remains.

Do not equate epistemic humility with universal scepticism. A standpoint is assessable by whether it captures a real aspect; not every claim is equally valid.



Advanced objections and replies

Contradiction: "is" and "is not" cannot both be true. The Jaina reply is that they are never asserted in the same respect, relation, place and time. Qualification preserves rather than violates non-contradiction.

Redundancy: why exactly seven forms? They systematically combine affirmation, negation and inexpressibility without repeating a logical possibility.

Self-refutation: if all claims are conditional, is *anekāntavāda* itself merely conditional? The strongest Jaina reply distinguishes the minimal unconditional insight that finite unqualified predication is incomplete from an exhaustive absolutist description of reality.

The omniscience cost: *kevala-jñāna* prevents the system from becoming total relativism, but its independent proof remains difficult. Thus Jainism is better classified as qualified or non-absolutist realism, not relativism in the sense that every opinion is equally true.

□ **2026 conceptual anchor:** recent public and educational discussions around Mahāvira Jayanti again used *anekāntavāda* as a resource for dialogue amid polarization. This is an application analogy only, not evidence for the classical doctrine.



Advanced objections, replies and ethical refinements

The distinctive strength of Jaina karma theory is its integration of psychology, ethics and embodiment: *bhāvabandha* explains inner adhesiveness, while *dravyabandha* explains objective karmic continuity. Its deepest metaphysical weakness is interaction: how does material *pudgala* bind an intrinsically conscious soul?

Beginningless bondage avoids the need for a first moral fall, but creates another question: if the soul is naturally perfect, why is obscuration beginningless? Jainism answers operationally rather than historically—liberation requires removing present causes and accumulated matter.

The fourteen *guṇasthānas* make liberation gradual and technically ordered. The *sayoga-kevalī* stage is important because omniscience can occur while minimal embodied activity remains; final disembodied liberation follows later.

Sallekhanā must be analysed by intention, conditions and passionlessness. In its ideal doctrinal form it is a disciplined thinning of attachment at life's appropriate end, not impulsive self-destruction. Contemporary legal or medical claims require separate case-specific verification.



Advanced dialectical verdict

Śaṅkara and Rāmānuja press the law of non-contradiction: a real cannot possess opposed attributes. The Jaina reply succeeds where predicates are explicitly indexed, but it still must explain the universal status of its own many-sided ontology.

Buddhist criticism challenges the permanent-yet-changing soul. Jainism gains moral agency and numerical continuity, while Buddhism gains ontological economy. Neither side wins without choosing a criterion—continuity, parsimony or explanatory adequacy.

Nyāya's interaction and extension objections expose a genuine pressure point. The lamp-light analogy makes bodily co-extension intelligible, but does not fully explain material karma's contact with consciousness.

Cārvāka's evidential challenge is strongest against higher cognition and liberation. Jaina internal coherence is not by itself external verification. The defensible final classification is **pluralistic, realistic and non-absolutist**, with acknowledged burdens concerning omniscience, soul-matter interaction and reflexive qualification.



Advanced synthesis

The safest overall verdict is **qualified realism**. Jainism is realist because substances, souls, matter and modes exist independently of our descriptions. It is pluralist because no single substance or consciousness absorbs the rest. It is non-absolutist because finite predication captures aspects rather than the exhaustive whole.

Its achievement is architectural: permanence and change, truth and humility, agency and embodiment, ethics and liberation are integrated in one system. Its costs are equally systematic: taxonomy can become heavy; omniscience is difficult to verify; karmic matter creates an interaction problem; and the doctrine must reserve enough unconditional truth to state its own non-absolutism.

The final answer should never conclude "all viewpoints are true". The stronger conclusion is that viewpoints are conditionally valid when they track objective aspects and become false when absolutised.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER RETRIEVAL



A. System identity

- Printed syllabus: theory of reality; *saptabhaṅginaya*; bondage and liberation.
- Shared textual anchor: Umāsvāti/Umāsvāmī's *Tattvārthasūtra*.

- Non-creator framework; Tirthaṅkaras are liberated teachers.

- Path: right vision, right knowledge and right conduct.



B. Reality

- *Sat* possesses *utpāda*, *vyaya* and *dhrauvya*.

- Substance persists while modes originate and cease.

- Six *dravyas*: *jīva*, *pudgala*, *dharma*, *adharma*, *ākāśa* and *kāla*.

- Five are *astikāyas*; time is a *dravya* but not an *astikāya*.



C. Substance and soul

- Every *dravya* has abiding *guṇas* and changing *pariāyas*.

- Many *jīvas* are real, beginningless and intrinsically conscious.

- *Pudgala* includes bodies, sense objects and karmic matter.

- *Dharma*/*adharma* are media of motion/rest, not merit/demerit.



D. Knowledge

- Strict Jaina *pratyakṣa* is unmediated soul-direct knowledge.

- *Mati* and *śruta* are mediated; *avadhi*, *manaḥpariyāya* and *kevala* are strictly direct.

- Ordinary cognition is karmically partial.

- *Kevala-jñāna* is complete, unobstructed knowledge.



E. Many-sided judgement

- *Anekānta*: objective many-sidedness.

- *Naya*: legitimate partial standpoint.

- *Syāt*: “in some respect,” preventing absolutisation.

- Partial truth becomes error when presented as exhaustive.



F. Sevenfold predication

- somehow it is;
- somehow it is not;
- somehow it is and is not;
- somehow it is inexpressible;
- somehow it is and is inexpressible;
- somehow it is not and is inexpressible;
- somehow it is, is not and is inexpressible.

Opposites are indexed to substance, place, time and mode; *avaktavya* is not mere ignorance.



G. Absolutism objection

- Critic: universal non-absolutism seems self-defeating.
- Reply: objective many-sidedness grounds conditional finite claims.
- Omniscience supplies a complete standpoint within the system.
- Residual burden: justify omniscience and the doctrine's own universal reach.



H. Karma (action and its morally consequential residue) and bondage

- Karma is subtle material *pudgala*.
- Activity brings influx; passion fixes and intensifies it.
- Bhāvabandha is psychic bondage; dravyabandha is material adhesion.
- Four parameters: type, duration, intensity and quantity.



I. Liberation sequence

ĀSRAVA (influx of karmic matter) -> BANDHA (bondage) -> SAṂVARA (stoppage of karmic influx) -> NIRJARĀ (shedding of accumulated karma) -> MOKṢA (liberation)

- Saṁvara stops new karma; nirjarā removes old karma.
- Liberation is subtraction of obstruction, not merger or annihilation.
- The siddha remains an individual omniscient soul.



J. Ethics and stages

- Five vows: ahiṃsā, satya, asteya, brahmacarya and aparigraha.
- Seven tattvas become nine padārthas by adding puṇya and pāpa.
- Eight karma types divide into ghātiyā and aghātiyā.
- Fourteen *guṇasthānas* culminate in sayoga- and ayoga-kevalī.



K. Criticism–reply grid

Critic	Pressure	Jaina reply
Śaṅkara/Rāmānuja	contradiction	different respects and modes
Buddhist	permanence plus change	dravya (substance) persists; paryāya (changing mode) changes
Nyāya (school of logic and epistemology)	soul–matter interaction	jīva (living conscious substance or soul) has pradeśas (plural form: quantity of karmic particles or spatial points); karmic matter is subtle
Empiricist	omniscience unverifiable	inference, testimony and system coherence



L. Final answer discipline

- Identify the exact syllabus limb.
- Define terms before listing classifications.
- Link reality to judgement or karma to liberation.
- Preserve ordered sequences exactly.
- State one named objection and the Jaina reply.
- Distinguish internal coherence from external proof.

- Conclude with qualified realism, not “all views are true.”

Final judgement: Jainism achieves a powerful integration of permanence and change, realism and humility, and ethics and liberation; its hardest costs are the material soul–karma interaction and the epistemic burden of omniscience.

PYQ ROUTES, COMPARISON & ANSWER SPINE

Use: identify the directive -> state the thesis -> define the doctrine -> derive the mechanism -> present objection and reply -> compare only where demanded -> qualify the verdict. Full solved prose remains in the workbook.



VERIFIED PYQS — 9 COMPLETE SOLUTIONS



2018 · Q6(c) · 15 marks

Question: How do the Jaina philosophers explain 'bondage'? What, according to them, is the distinction between 'liberated soul' and 'bound soul'? What do the Jainas think about the condition of the 'liberated soul'? Discuss.

Demand decoding

- Compare the bound and liberated soul on identity, embodiment, cognition and destiny.
- “Discuss” requires one conceptual difficulty and a balanced conclusion.

Jainism explains bondage as the beginningless but terminable association of conscious **jīva** with subtle material **karma-pudgala**. The soul is intrinsically capable of infinite knowledge, perception, energy and bliss, yet activity of body, speech and mind (**yoga**), when coloured by delusion and the passions of anger, pride, deceit and greed, attracts karmic matter.

Bound soul	Liberated soul
Embodied and co-extensive with its body	Bodiless siddha (liberated perfected soul)
Knowledge and perception obscured	Kevala-jñāna (perfect omniscience) and perfect perception manifest
Subject to pleasure, pain, birth and death	Beyond suffering and rebirth
Conditioned by all eight karma-prakṛtis (types or species of karma)	Entirely free from karmic matter
Moves through saṃsāra (cycle of rebirth and suffering)	Abides at siddha-śīlā (realm of liberated souls)

Why this earns marks

- Uses the complete āsrava–bandha–saṃvara–nirjarā route.
- Compares bound and liberated souls across five examinable dimensions.
- Adds a precise interaction objection without displacing doctrinal exposition.

**2019 · Q6(a) · 20 marks**

Question: How is reality defined by the Jainas? How is this theory of reality reflected in their view on judgements? Discuss. Discuss.

Demand decoding

- “Discuss” requires illustration, criticism, reply and a qualified verdict.

A jar exists here and now as a jar, does not exist as cloth or as a future destroyed jar, and is *avaktavya* when temporally and modally distinct determinations are demanded in one simple, simultaneous utterance. The scheme does not affirm P and not-P in the same respect, place, time and mode.

Śaṃkara objects that opposed predicates destroy determinate knowledge and that *anekāntavāda* either asserts itself absolutely or loses universal force. The Jaina reply indexes predication to **dravya, kṣetra, kāla and bhāva** and reflexively applies *syāt* to its own doctrine. Moreover, finite judgement is standpoint-bound, whereas *kevala-jñāna* is comprehensive.

Thus Jaina judgement is not scepticism or subjective relativism. It is the linguistic discipline demanded by a pluralistic realism. Its strength is the reconciliation of identity, change and cognitive humility; its burden is independently justifying omniscience and the status of its own universal claims.

Why this earns marks

- Engages Śaṃkara and ends with a genuinely critical verdict.

**2020 · Q5(a) · 10 marks**

Question: Examine the concept of Karma according to Jainism. How does it bear upon their conception of Liberation?

Demand decoding

- “Examine” requires a compact conceptual assessment, not only description.

Jainism treats karma not merely as moral law, merit-demerit or unseen potency, but as subtle **material pudgala**. Activity of body, speech and mind produces **āsrava**, while delusion and the four **kaṣāyas**—anger, pride, deceit and greed—make the soul receptive to karmic matter. Its attachment is **bandha**, which obscures the jīva’s intrinsic knowledge, perception, energy and bliss.

Why this earns marks

- Includes one concise internal strength and one residual objection.

**2021 · Q7(c) · 15 marks****Demand decoding**

- Explain *avaktavya* and answer the contradiction objection.

The Jaina sevenfold judgement is the formal expression of a many-sided reality. **Anekāntavāda** is the metaphysical thesis that a real has multiple aspects; **nayavāda** explains that finite cognition approaches it through partial standpoints; **syādvāda** requires each finite assertion to be qualified by *syāt*, “in some respect.” Saptabhaṅgi is therefore not a list of seven *nayas* but a schema of seven conditioned predications.

A jar exists as a present jar at a given place; it does not exist as cloth, elsewhere, or after destruction. It may be called inexpressible where a single unqualified utterance is asked to express jointly what belongs to different times, modes or relations. *Avaktavya* therefore does not mean sheer ignorance or mystical silence; it marks a limitation of simple simultaneous predication.

Critics such as Śaṅkara and Rāmānuja argue that “is” and “is not” threaten non-contradiction. The Jaina reply is that contradiction arises only when opposed predicates attach in the same respect, place, time and mode. *Syāt* expressly prevents that collapse.

Why this earns marks

- Presents the named contradiction criticism and the indexed Jaina reply.



2022 · Q5(d) · 10 marks

Question: How does Jaina view of Karma bear upon their soteriology? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

- “Critically discuss” requires a balanced evaluative close.

Why this earns marks



2022 · Q6(b) · 15 marks

Question: ‘The doctrine of Relativism of Jain Philosophy cannot be logically sustained without postulating ‘Absolutism’.’ Critically examine this view and give reasons in the favour of your answer.

Demand decoding

- Reconstruct the self-reference and universal-scope objection fairly.
- Give explicit reasons for a defended conclusion.

The objection identifies a reflexive difficulty. If every proposition is only relatively true, then “every proposition is relative” is itself relative and cannot govern all judgements. If Jainism asserts *anekāntavāda* universally, it appears to make an absolute exception for itself. Further, doctrines such as real *dravyas*, the soul’s intrinsic consciousness and *kevala-jñāna* seem to claim more than local validity.

Therefore Jaina relativism cannot survive as total relativism; nor need it. The coherent doctrine is qualified pluralistic realism: objective reality, graded cognition and anti-absolutism concerning finite predication. It concedes a minimal framework of truth while rejecting one-sided claims to exhaustive truth.

Why this earns marks

- States the self-reference objection in its strongest logical form.
- Explains how *kevala-jñāna* functions in the Jaina reply.

- Gives clear reasons for a nuanced verdict rather than a binary yes/no.



2023 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

Question: “All human knowledge is empirical and therefore relative.” Critically examine Jaina theory of sevenfold judgement (saptabhaṅginaya) in the light of above statement.

Demand decoding

- Evaluate, rather than simply accept, the quotation.

Why this earns marks

- Adds the precise kevala-jñāna objection and reply.



2024 · Q6(c) · 15 marks

Question: What is the distinction between Bhāvabandha and Dravyabandha, according to the Jainas? Discuss.

Demand decoding

- “Discuss” warrants the four bandha parameters and one critical issue.

Yoga, activity of body, speech and mind, brings karmic matter into relation with the soul. Passion fixes it deeply. Material bondage is further analysed through four parameters: **prakṛti** (type), **sthiti** (duration), **anubhāga/rasa** (intensity) and **pradeśa** (quantity). Yoga chiefly determines type and quantity; kaṣāya chiefly determines duration and intensity. Thus identical outward acts can have different karmic consequences according to inner passion.

Why this earns marks



2025 · Q7(c) · 15 marks

Question: Is Jaina philosophy pluralistic and realistic? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

- Critically discuss objections to permanence-in-change and qualified predication.

Three objections remain. Śaṅkara argues that opposed predicates threaten non-contradiction; the Jaina reply separates their respects. A Buddhist critic rejects the enduring substance beneath changing modes; Jainism invokes *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya*. The self-refutation objection asks whether anekāntavāda absolutises its own relativity; Jainism reflexively qualifies finite discourse and reserves comprehensive cognition for kevala-jñāna.

Why this earns marks



Original 1 · 10 marks**Demand decoding****Why this earns marks****Original 2 · 10 marks**

Question: Why is the Jaina classification of pratyakṣa described as an “inversion” of ordinary epistemological usage? Examine.

Demand decoding

- Explain the philosophical function and one objection.

Nyāya may object that knowledge without sense-contact is not perceptual, while the higher jñānas lack ordinary verification. Jainism replies that metaphysical directness concerns absence of mediation, though the empirical objection to extraordinary cognition remains.

Why this earns marks

- Introduces a named Nyāya objection.
- Gives a qualified rather than dogmatic conclusion.

**Original 3 · 15 marks**

Question: Does saptabhaṅgī violate the law of non-contradiction? Critically examine.

Demand decoding

- Examine the third and *avaktavya*-bearing bhangas.
- Present the classical objection, Jaina reply and residual condition of success.

The fourth, *syād avaktavyam*, marks the inability of one simple utterance to express jointly a complex of differently indexed aspects. It does not mean that the object is unknowable. The remaining bhangas combine *avaktavya* with affirmation, negation, and both.

Why this earns marks

- Names Śaṅkara and Rāmānuja and supplies the dravya–paryāya reply.
- Adds the self-reference issue and a conditional verdict.



Original 4 · 15 marks**Demand decoding**

Each act also binds karma under four parameters: **prakṛti** or type, **sthiti** or duration, **anubhāga** or intensity, and **pradeśa** or quantity. Yoga—the activity of body, speech and mind—chiefly determines type and quantity. Kaṣāya—anger, pride, deceit and greed—chiefly determines duration and intensity. Passionless activity therefore has a different karmic result from outwardly similar passion-coloured activity.

The framework joins external conduct to inner agency. It avoids reducing responsibility either to intention alone or to physical movement alone: action brings karma, while passion fixes it. Its strength is causal and ethical granularity. Its weakness is metaphysical elaborateness and the obscure interaction between conscious states and material particles.

Why this earns marks**Original 5 · 20 marks****Demand decoding**

- Explain continuity and change in the soul, with criticisms and a reasoned verdict.

Transformation is nevertheless real at the level of modes. The bound jīva is embodied, contracts or expands with its body, undergoes pleasure and pain and moves through rebirth. Progress through the fourteen guṇasthānas gradually removes delusion and passion. At stage thirteen, the sayoga-kevalī has destroyed the ghātiyā karmas and manifests omniscience while residual aghātiyā karmas sustain embodiment. At stage fourteen, activity ceases; after the remaining karma is exhausted, the bodiless siddha abides at siddha-śīlā, beyond rebirth.

Why this earns marks

- Ends with a synthesis that preserves both continuity and transformation.

**Original 6 · 20 marks**

Question: Can Jaina pluralistic realism consistently sustain both epistemic humility and the claim to omniscience? Critically discuss.

Demand decoding

- Reach a graded verdict rather than dismissing either side.

This reply has three strengths. First, it prevents humility from collapsing into scepticism: standpoints track objective aspects. Second, it gives soteriology an epistemic goal: purification enlarges cognition. Third, it allows the doctrine to explain its own possibility—comprehensive teaching ultimately rests on kevalin knowledge.

Why this earns marks

- States the circularity and verification objections in strong form.
- Gives the graded-knowledge and karmic-obstruction reply.
- Delivers a graded verdict separating logical compatibility from evidential proof.

FINAL RAPID-RECALL SEQUENCE

01. 0. ONE-SCREEN MAP	02. 0A. UMĀSVĀTI / UMĀSVĀMĪ AND THE TATTVĀRTHASŪTRA (Aphorisms on the Meaning of Reality) FACT:
03. 1. THEORY OF REALITY FACT:	04. 1A. JAINA PRAMĀṆA (means of valid knowledge) SCHEME: THE EPISTEMIC GROUND OF ANEKĀNTAVĀDA (doctrine of many-sided reality) FACT:
05. 2. SAPTABHAṆĠĪNAYA (sevenfold standpoint-based judgement) FACT:	06. 3. BONDAGE AND LIBERATION FACT:
07. 3A. SEVEN TATTVAS (fundamental categories of reality and liberation) AND NINE PADĀRTHAS (ontological categories) FACT:	08. 3B. EIGHT KARMA-PRAKṚTIS (types or species of karma) AND THE MECHANICS OF BANDHA (bondage) FACT:
09. 3C. FOURTEEN GUṆASTHĀNAS (fourteen stages of spiritual development): STAGES OF SPIRITUAL DEVELOPMENT FACT:	10. 3D. SALLEKHANĀ (ritual thinning of passions and body near unavoidable death) / SANTHĀRĀ (vow of disciplined fasting near unavoidable death): DEATH WITHOUT PASSION FACT:
11. 4. INTER-THINKER / INTER-SCHOOL DEBATES CAUTION:	12. 5. NAMED CRITICISMS AND JAINA REPLIES FACT:
13. 6. COMMON UPSC TRAPS FACT:	14. 7. KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK FACT: